

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Preparation of the 11th Consultation

Combating discrimination in education

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the **right to education** and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

2. Scope of the Consultation

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of

Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**¹ (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the **Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education**², which suggests to broaden our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the **Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education**³, and the **Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit**⁴ which call for the transformation of education systems to 'include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background'. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education⁵ and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.⁶

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO's Constitution states that "*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving>

² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707>

³ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf

⁴ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf

⁵ [Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/marrakech-framework-for-action)

⁶ [Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022)

4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be **participatory**. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and **civil society organizations** and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide **substantive and relevant information in a concise manner**. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the **Observatory on the right to education**⁷ in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for **HerAtlas**⁸, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database⁹. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

- The **first chapter** covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The **second chapter** aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education (section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).
- The **third chapter** seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, **two types of guidance** are provided:

⁷ <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en>

⁸ <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights>

⁹ [UIS Statistics \(unesco.org\)](https://uis.unesco.org)

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: Georgia

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report:

Name of contact person:

Email and telephone number of contact person:

I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹⁰

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ Yes

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☐ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☐ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

☐ No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?¹¹

☒ No

¹⁰

<https://www.unesco.org/en/legal-affairs/convention-against-discrimination-education>

¹¹

Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

☐ Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

*It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “**ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all**” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.¹²*

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☒ Yes ☐ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

- Article 27 of **Constitution of Georgia**, adopted on 24 August 1995 states that everyone shall have the right to receive education and the right to free choice of a form of Education. Inclusive education in Georgia is regulated by the Law on “Early and Preschool Education”, “General Education”, “Vocational Education” and the National Curriculum.
- **Legal framework determining the Georgian education** policy namely, Law of Georgia on Early and Preschool Education and Care, the Law of Georgia on General Education, the Law of Georgia on Vocational Education and the Law of Georgia on Higher Education is distinguished by the anti-discriminatory approach.
- **Law of Georgia on Early and Preschool Education and Care** ensures preschool education, including the school readiness program, which is voluntary, universal and available for every child of relevant age. The Laws of Early and Preschool, General and Vocation Education are harmonized with the Convention on the Right of People with Disabilities.

¹² Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

- **Law of Georgia on General Education** provides for the right to education for all and equal access to education for all.

Article 13 - Neutrality and non-discrimination

1. Politicization of the study process in general education institutions shall be inadmissible.
2. The use of the study process in general education institutions for the purpose of religious indoctrination, proselytism or forced assimilation shall be inadmissible. This rule shall not restrict the celebration of public holidays and historical dates in public schools, as well as the organisation of such events that are intended to establish national and universal values.
3. Any discrimination on admission to a school shall be inadmissible. This rule shall not exclude the possibility of holding a competitive selection in general education institutions that carry out military, specialized arts and sports trainings, as well as in schools with other status. Special educational needs of a person must be considered in a competitive selection.
4. It shall be inadmissible for schools to use their powers and resources in a way to directly or indirectly discriminate against pupils, parents, teachers or their associations.
5. Any differentiating act or an exception shall be considered as discrimination, except for the cases where such act or exception is fair and reasonable and ensures free development of and equal opportunities for each person and group.
6. Schools shall observe and facilitate tolerance and mutual respect among pupils, parents and teachers irrespective of their social, ethnic, religious, linguistic and world-view affiliations.
7. Schools shall protect individual and collective rights of minorities to freely use their native language, preserve and manifest their cultural affiliation on the basis of equality.

Article 26 - Authority of the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia in the field of general education

1. On the basis of the legislation of Georgia in the field of general education, in particular the Constitution of Georgia, the Constitutional Agreement, international agreements and treaties of Georgia, this Law, other laws and secondary legislation, the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia shall:

l) take the measures necessary for acquisition of education by all pupils, including pupils with special educational needs and pupils expelled from school; develop provisions for certifying external education; develop provisions for moving pupils from one general education institution to another general education institution; develop provisions for alternative ways to acquire education; develop the procedures for introducing, developing and monitoring inclusive education, as well as the mechanisms for identifying pupils with special educational needs;

Since 2005 the Ministry of Education, Science and Youth of Georgia started to develop Inclusive Education at General Education level. Law on General Education and National Curriculum recognize the individual and alternative forms of Education. For accessible and quality education additional services for SENs in Public schools are developed.

- According to the wording of the **Law of Georgia on Vocational Education**, everyone has the right to receive professional education in accordance with the rules established by the legislation of Georgia, without any discrimination. The Law of Georgia on Vocational Education establishes the goals of state policy in the field of vocational education: a) promoting the development of the country's economy; b) promotion of social inclusion, personal and professional development of an individual; c) promotion of lifelong learning; d) Convergence

and compatibility of Georgian vocational education system with the common European educational space.

- **Law of Georgia on Higher Education** envisages equal treatment towards students and academic personnel and prohibits any forms of discrimination in the field of higher education, including discrimination on any ground such as academic, ethnic, social or religious affiliation, and/or opinion, sex and other grounds; also, promotion of the development of Georgian and global cultural values, orientation towards the ideals of democracy and humanism essential for the existence and development of a civil society is one of the goals of higher education.

The Law of Georgia on Higher Education (amendment 14/12/2022) also defines the special teacher training educational program which is a higher education programme based on the relevant standard, independent from the Integrated Bachelor's and Master's Educational Programme of Teacher Training and Bachelor's Educational Programme, the learning outcomes of which are consistent with the general learning outcomes set for Level 6 of the National Qualifications Framework; After completing the special teacher training program a certificate will be issued. The Sector Benchmark is used during the development of a special teacher training educational program. A special education teacher is one of the main actors in providing a teaching-learning process and environment adapted to students with special educational needs.

Special teacher training is provided in educational institutions (schools, preschools, etc.), day care centers, etc. To prepare a person with appropriate qualifications, knowledge, skills and responsibilities for students with special educational needs.

One of the bases for the development of the sectoral characteristic is:

- "Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities"
- UNESCO Salamanca Declaration;
- Children's Rights Convention;
- Georgia-EU Association Agreement of June 27, 2014;
- Law of Georgia on elimination of all forms of discrimination;
- "Child's Rights Code" of September 1, 2020.
- Other regulatory documents.

<https://ege.ge/ka/page/static/1025/ganatileba>

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation¹³, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b¹⁴

¹³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

¹⁴ Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes".

☒ Legal texts¹⁵ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

- **Constitution of Georgia, Article 35**

Article 35 of Constitution of Georgia, adopted on 24 August 1995 (Last amendment 27.12.06) states that everyone shall have the right to receive education and the right to free choice of a form of Education. Inclusive education in Georgia is regulated by the Law on “Early and Preschool Education”, “General Education”, “Vocational Education” and the National Curriculum. The Laws of Early and Preschool, General and Vocation Education are harmonized to the Convention on the Right of People with Disability.

- **Law of Georgia on On Early and Preschool Education**

Article 7- Powers and/or obligations of the Government of Georgia in the field of early and preschool education

In order to ensure equal and qualified early and preschool education that is based on the principle of the protection of the best interests of children in the entire territory of the country, the Government of Georgia shall exercise the following powers and fulfil the following obligations:

a) to ensure the universal availability of early and preschool education programmes, including the school readiness programme, within the scopes of the legal regulation of the rights of children and their parents and/or legal representatives;

Article 10- Powers and/or obligations of municipalities in the field of preschool education

1. On the basis of the legislation of Georgia in the field of preschool education, the Constitution of Georgia, the international agreements and treaties of Georgia, this Law, and other laws and subordinate legislative acts of Georgia municipalities shall:

- a) ensure the delivery of preschool education services in compliance with state standards;
- b) ensure the delivery of equally available and inclusive preschool education;

- **Law of Georgia on General Education**

Article 9 - Right to acquire general education

1. Everyone shall enjoy equal rights to acquire a complete general education in order to fully develop his/her personality and acquire knowledge and skills necessary for equal opportunities

to be successful in private and social life. Acquisition of a primary and basic education shall be mandatory.

- **New law on the Vocational Education** was adopted in September 2018, aiming at (1) improving the quality and flexibility of the vocational education system, (2) establishing links with general, vocational and higher education, (3) integrating general education in the vocational education programs, (4) accumulation and transferring the credits; (5) development of adult educational system etc. Within the framework of the law on vocational education a new national qualifications framework and new standards for quality assurance of vocational education were developed and introduced, mechanisms for recognizing non-formal education and a systematic approach to vocational training and retraining of adults were developed. A unified rule for enrollment in vocational educational programs was introduced, which provides unified approaches to the admission of students in both private and public institutions; The integration of a general educational component in vocational education, opened up possibility of continuing studies at the higher education level with a vocational diploma; Forms of work-based learning were introduced, which helped to increase the interest of the private sector and the transition of graduates to the labor market. In order to introduce even more effective and systematic mechanisms of public-private partnership, in 2021 based on consultations with employers' associations operating in Georgia and their expressed readiness, the Georgian Chamber of Commerce & Industry and the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia jointly established a non-profit (non-commercial) legal entity - Skills Agency. Skills Agency aims to facilitate the introduction of vocational programs in the labor market, support innovative training, increase competition and provide better employment opportunities.
- **Law of Georgia on Higher Education** envisages equal treatment towards students and academic personnel and prohibits any forms of discrimination in the field of higher education, including discrimination on any ground such as academic, ethnic, social or religious affiliation, and/or opinion, sex and other grounds; also, promotion of the development of Georgian and global cultural values, orientation towards the ideals of democracy and humanism essential for the existence and development of a civil society is one of the goals of higher education.
- **Authorization Standards** approved by the Minister of Education and Science Order No 99/n, 1.10.2010

According to the Authorization Standards for Higher Education Institutions, universities are required to have developed codes of ethics and conduct for students and staff, and defined procedures for responding to the violation of these regulations; Administration of the institution, should constantly promote ethical code and conduct norms.

- Decree No. 06 / N of January 29, 2019 issued by the Minister of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of Georgia on „Rules and Conditions for Safety and Public Order in Educational Institutions“ is a comprehensive document that provides guidance on safety and security measures for schools and educational institutions. The document outlines specific prevention and response procedures to protect students, staff, and the general public from potential threats and maintain public order within school premises during school hours.

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

- **Constitution of Georgia**, – Article 27 – Right to education and academic freedom

Everyone has the right to receive education and the right to choose the form of education they receive; 2. Pre-school education shall be guaranteed in accordance with the procedures established by law. Elementary and basic education shall be compulsory. General education shall be fully funded by the State, in accordance with the procedures established by law. Citizens shall have the right to state-funded vocational and higher education, in accordance with the procedures established by law.

- **The Law of Georgia - The Code on the Rights of the Child, Article 10 – Right of the child to Education**

All children shall have the right to obtain and have equal access to high-quality and inclusive Education;

The State shall ensure that the inclusive education system is equally accessible to all children;

- **The Law of Georgia on Early and Preschool Education**

Article 4- The principles of preschool education - 2. Preschool education, including the school readiness programme, is voluntary, universal and available for every child of relevant age.

Article 7- Powers and/or obligations of the Government of Georgia in the field of early and preschool education - ensure the universal availability of early and preschool education programmes, including the school readiness programme, within the scopes of the legal regulation of the rights of children and their parents and/or legal representatives;

- **The Decree N488 of October 30, 2017 “On the approval of Early and preschool education and care state standards”.**

Article 16 standard 7 Inclusion and diversity – ECEC program ensures equal participation of each child, regardless of their abilities; The program recognizes and respects cultural diversity and the different abilities and needs of children.

- **According to the Authorisation standards of General Education Institutions** schools are obliged to fulfil the following requirements:

3.5.1.4. School infrastructure provides inclusive learning environment;

2.1.2.4. The learning process is inclusive and takes into account the differentiated approaches;

- **The Law of Georgia on Vocational Education**

Article 4 - Right to receive vocational education and basic guarantees

- Everyone has the right to exercise, without any discrimination, the right to receive vocational education in accordance with the procedure established by the legislation of Georgia.
- Vocational students, listeners, and vocational education teachers and their associations, shall have the right to exercise, without any discrimination, all the rights and freedoms defined by the legislation of Georgia and educational institutions.
- Educational institutions shall ensure the availability of an individually tailored learning process and necessary special educational services, as well as access to a learning

environment in the educational institution, for persons with special educational needs and persons with disabilities

- **The Law of Georgia on Higher Education**

Article 3 - Goals of higher education

The goals of higher education are determined by the law of Georgia on higher education.

In order to achieve the goals determined by Article 3 the State shall ensure:

- a) access to and openness of higher education and academic freedom in learning, teaching and scientific research;
- b) the opportunity to acquire higher education at any time during a person's lifetime;
- c) the integration of higher education and science;
- d) the development of quality assurance systems, which implies the functioning of authorization and accreditation systems, and quality management assurance mechanisms at higher education institutions;
- e) full participation in a unified European educational and research area for the processes of learning, teaching and for conducting scientific research works, as well as in other international systems of cooperation;
- f) the autonomy of higher education institutions;
- g) the participation of academic personnel, scientific personnel and students of a higher education institution in the process of making decisions and monitoring of their execution;
- h) the prevention of any forms of discrimination in the field of higher education, including academic, religious or ethnic discrimination, as well as discrimination on the grounds of opinion, gender, social origin and others;
- i) publicity and transparency of the management of higher education institutions and of the competitions held in these institutions;
- j) the provision of other conditions that facilitate achievement of the goals specified by paragraph 1 of this article.

☒ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☒ In primary education

☒ In secondary education

☒ In technical and vocational education and training

☒ In higher education

☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

The Ministry nearly 18 years develops Inclusive Education. **Article 35 of Constitution of Georgia**, adopted on 24 August 1995 (Last amendment 27.12.06) states that everyone shall have the right to receive education and the right to free choice of a form of Education. Inclusive education in Georgia is regulated by the Law on "Early and Preschool Education", "General Education", "Vocational Education" and the National Curriculum. The Laws of Early and Preschool, General and Vocation Education are harmonized to the Convention on the Right of People with Disability.

Since 2005 the Ministry started to develop **Inclusive Education** at General Education level. Law on General Education and National Curriculum recognize the individual and alternative forms of Education. For accessible and quality education developed additional services for SENs in Public schools.

In Georgia special education needs (SEN) of a pupil is based on the assessment and conclusion of the multidisciplinary team. A multidisciplinary team was created, which consists of 50 members and covers the whole Georgia. The team consists of different specialists (psychologist, special teacher, occupational therapist, psychiatrist), whose function is to determine special educational needs (SEN) in accordance with standardized tests and develop recommendations for schools in teaching and learning.

The number of SEN students is increasing in public schools. In the beginning, the number of SEN students was only a few hundred, while the number has reached 13,123 in public schools by April 2024.

The model of school funding has changed since September 1, 2013, and the schools where SEN students are enrolled receive additional funding to ensure their education. In 2013, funding amounted to GEL 350 for every six SEN students and since 2021, the funding has increased to GEL 700 for every five students.

In 2018, amendments were made to the Law of Georgia on General Education, determining the special teacher as one of the types of teachers. The standard of special teacher was approved as well as the career advancement and professional development scheme was defined. Currently, 2253 special education teachers are employed in schools, out of whom 10 are lead and 1505 senior teachers. From June 2023 to March 2024, 151 special education teachers were granted the status of a senior teacher.

By the Order N86/N of the Minister of Education, Science and Youth of Georgia dated April 1, 2024, the "Rule of conducting the basic professional skills test" was approved. From April 3 to April 15, 2024, registration for the basic professional skills test is underway by the National Assessment and Examinations Center (NAEC). Successful passing of the test is a prerequisite for enrolment in the special teacher training educational program. More than 16,000 applicants registered for the 2023 teacher subject exam, and about 2,500 examinees registered for the senior special teacher exam. The exam started on the 6th of July and concluded on the 24th of July. More than 82% of the 18,500 applicants were present for the exams.

The procedure for the introduction, development and monitoring of inclusive education were approved as well as the mechanism for the identification of students with special educational needs. The mechanism regulated the progression of inclusive education in the school as well as the process of determining the status of SEN students by a multidisciplinary team. The additional specialists who should work with the SEN student were defined – psychologist, occupational therapist, speech therapist, sign language interpreter, sign language specialist, orientation and mobility specialist, assistant of a person with special educational needs.

The Ministry is developing numerous auxiliary resources, guides, manuals, which serve to promote the education of the SEN student and are intended for specialists, teachers, and

parents. Alternative curricula are a part of the National Curriculum. If it is impossible for a SEN student to learn some of the subjects specified in the National Curriculum, the Alternative Curriculum is a document that includes and describes the standard of the subjects, the teaching recommendations, the means of achievement, the functional skills and the knowledge acquisition. According to the alternative curriculum, each subject is taught using a variety of learning strategies and gives the student functional and academic knowledge. Part of the National Curriculum is an alternative curriculum for students with severe and multiple mental disorders and autism spectrum disorders; Sensory curriculum for students with severe and multiple mental and physical development disorders; Advanced curriculum for students with visual impairments; Mobility-Orientation Standard. A standard for teaching Georgian sign language at the elementary level, a curriculum for lowering and accelerated learning for those who are left out of compulsory education. Textbooks are printed in Braille for visually impaired students, and audio versions of the textbooks are also prepared. The Ministry ensures purchase of technical equipment in order to support the education of visually impaired students. Furthermore, infrastructural projects are implemented, and educational institutions are adapted. The SEN students are provided with transportation services.

In order to support inclusive education, LEPL - National Center for Teacher Vocational Training provides a variety of training modules, which aim to strengthen the school administration, special teachers, teachers, parents in the field of inclusive education.

Work has been completed on a 60-credit special teacher training program, which is planned to be launched in the 2024-2025 academic year. At the same time, in December, 2022 an amendment was introduced to the Law of Georgia on Higher Education, on the basis of which it is mandatory to integrate a special teacher training module in the integrated undergraduate and graduate teacher training program. Which will enable higher education institutions to train teachers who will at the same time have the right to special education and under the higher education program will pass appropriate teaching-learning strategies for students with diverse needs.

In order to support the professional development of a special teacher, in 2021, the sectoral benchmark of higher education in the teacher preparation educational program for special education teacher was prepared and approved by the Order of the Director of the National Center for Educational Quality Enhancement, MES 4 21 0001398735 of December 21, 2021. In 2022, changes were made to the teacher's professional development and career advancement scheme, and the status of a mentor special education teacher was added to the status of a special education teacher.

In order to provide the appropriate educational environment and teaching-learning process for students with special educational needs by general educational institutions, the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia has defined the registration of students with special educational needs as the first stage of registration of first graders since 2019. As a result, the multidisciplinary team is able to evaluate the registered first graders and then identify their special educational needs. This procedure allows the school to have information about the educational needs of future first-graders before the start of the new academic year. The given information is instrumental to determine what is required to be provided in order to organize an educational process tailored to the student's needs.

To strengthen the quality and inclusiveness of the educational system, since 2021, the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia in cooperation with the Government of Norway, and the United Nations Children's Fund has been implementing a joint three-year program called "No Child Without Education". Within the framework of the program, with the involvement of the stakeholders and foreign and Georgian experts, a new model of inclusive education support system has been developed. It entails the mobilization of various responsibilities and services

in a single space, which will greatly contribute to the coordinated management of existing resources, their efficient usage, and strengthening of required competencies. In addition, the new system ensures the strengthening of resource schools, the improvement of the counseling and transition components of public schools, the formation of effective operational teams, and the development of new support services, upon the needs. The new system envisages consistent, multitiered educational support, tailored to the individual needs and abilities of each child, which on its own helps to improve the quality of inclusive educational practices in the learning environment. In November 2023, an amendment was introduced to the Law of Georgia "On General Education", which, based on best Norwegian practice, creates the basis for the implementation of a new system supporting inclusive education in the Office of Resource Officers of Educational Institutions (ORO). The new model supporting inclusive education will enter into force from June 1, 2024. In the meantime, the process of setting up Inclusive and Special Education Support Center is underway at the Office of Resource Officers of Educational Institutions (ORO). The Center will coordinate the identification of special educational needs, counselling services, transition support processes, etc.

The Ministry of Education, Science and Youth of Georgia has created electronic support tool for the Georgian Braille font in order to foster access to education for blind pupils/students. Electronic braille support tool is integrated into the open-source, free software "liblui", which is built into various screen readers such as NVDA, JAWS, and others. As a result, blind people can read information displayed on a computer screen using an electronic braille display. It has also become possible to type text using the Braille keyboard, which allows blind people to fully use computers both in study and working environments, as well as in everyday life.

In December 2022, the Law of Georgia "On General Education" was amended, the term "transition" was defined, the measures supporting the transition were defined as part of the school curriculum, and the duties of the teacher and the general educational institution in relation to the support of the transitional process were defined as well.

On October 03, 2023, by order N1292040 of the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia, the "Inclusive Education Action Plan of the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia for 2023-2024" was approved. The Action plan aims to ensure accessibility and quality of education at all levels. The plan is based on 3 strategic priorities: 1. systematic strengthening and development of inclusive education; 2. development of inclusive education approaches, methodology and services at all levels of education; 3. promotion of professional development of human resources involved in inclusive education.

In 2023, two journal issues on "Inclusive Education" were prepared and published. "Inclusive Education" journal intends to create a communication space and collaborative network for open communication on important issues in the field.

In the course of 2023 Unified National Examinations, NAEC provided 220 entrants and 22 master's degree candidates with special examination conditions. As a result, 191 entrants and 14 candidates obtained the right to continue their studies.

For the 2023-2024 academic year, within the framework of the Social Program, state educational grant was awarded to 99 students who are severely/significantly/moderately disabled, a state educational grant was awarded to 1 student who is a person with the autism spectrum condition.

For the 2023-2024 academic year, within the framework of the social program, the state educational master's grant was awarded to 11 persons who are severely/significantly/moderately disabled persons.

In order to support the professional development of a special teacher, the Sectoral Benchmarks for Special Education (Teacher Education) for MA programs was prepared and was approved by the Order of the Director of the National Center for Educational Quality Enhancement (MES 0 23 0001779079 of December 29, 2023). The process of accreditation of the special teacher

training educational program by Ivane Javakhishvili Tbilisi State University (TSU) and Shota Rustaveli Batumi State University is ongoing.

The Government of Georgia approved the revised version of the "State Standards of Early and Preschool Care and Education" by Decree No. 264, on July 24, 2023. The revised standards focus on the Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC) community's attention on aspects of inclusive early childhood and preschool education, such as: ensuring a non-violent and non-discriminatory environment free from religious indoctrination and proselytism by ECEC institution employees; understanding of the principles of universal design by the staff and the possibility of independent assessment of needs for the involvement of children with special educational needs in educational processes and for their emotional safety; indicating the ownership of assistive technologies for working with children with disabilities; providing information to children and parents of ethnic minorities in their mother tongue.

Universal accessibility to VET and ensuring response to the needs of various vulnerable groups, including persons with disabilities and with special educational needs is reform priority. implementation of the inclusive vocational education system started since 2013. To support the learning process of VET students with special educational needs and disabilities various types of services are available: an inclusive vocational education specialist, learning process assistant, individual assistant, sign-language interpreter, orientation and mobility specialist. Adapted learning materials, individual study plans, transportation are constantly provided.

Since 2013 studying in state VET institutions is fully financed by the state, and since 2019 in private VET institutions in accordance with the priorities determined by the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia. Since 2017, VET students with special needs and disabilities are provided by the state with additional funding in the amount of 1000.0 GEL on a quarterly voucher. The mentioned amount is used to provide services tailored to the individual needs of abovementioned students. The VET institutions are fully adapted. Educational resources were developed, such as the electronic bank of Georgian sign-language (which is located on a special web page) and the mobile application of the mentioned bank, audio versions of vocational textbooks, guidelines related to vocational education were prepared. Furthermore, assistive technical devices are available. Professional development of teachers and specialists involved in inclusive vocational education is carried out.

In 2021, a unified rule of enrolment in educational institutions was introduced in the vocational education system (The Order of the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia 42/n adopted in July 2, 2021 "On the approval of the rules and conditions of enrolment in the professional educational program"), according to which, in 2021, for the first time it became possible to enrol VET students with unified enrolment procedures not only in public but in all private institutions. Thus, all authorized, including private institutions accept students only through a centralized admission, through a common platform. In accordance with the new enrolment rule 15% of the announced places are offered to the people with special needs. The admission process uses a variety of mechanisms, which, depending on the specifics of the program, provide a much more flexible approach to student selection. To confirm a special educational need, during online registration on the portal - vet.emis.ge, the applicant must check the box "person with special educational needs" in the registration column. The multidisciplinary team provides an assessment of the applicant and prepares relevant report, which will be reflected in the EMIS database. After the confirmation of the status, the selection of the person will be conducted based on a practical testing adapted to his/her individual needs and abilities, which is accompanied by a reflection process.

Currently, system is working on the implementation of continuous professional development opportunities for the inclusive education support specialists, which aims to strengthen competences of specialists and increase the quality of inclusive VET education. With the support of EU, a continuous professional development model was prepared, job descriptions of specialists were updated, and training modules were developed to prepare specialists to fulfil their professional activities effectively.

Since 2015, the MoESY has been implementing a special service "transit educational program for homeless children (children connected to the street)". The program includes the provision of education components to all beneficiaries receiving the services of day care centers and shelters. The goal of the program is socialization of homeless children, integration into formal education and prevention of early school leaving.

The program works in several main directions, namely:

- promoting the development of life skills;
- Facilitating the development of academic skills for out-of-school beneficiaries, and with beneficiaries at high risk of dropping out, specialists work to support the coping in school program;
- Sports and cultural events, excursions to improve socialization with peers;
- professional orientation program for selecting a professional program in colleges after completing compulsory general education and continuing to study on it;
- An information campaign to raise public awareness of the child's right to education and the needs of vulnerable children in order to raise the awareness of teachers, management representatives and parents of classmates of the beneficiary public schools in order to overcome the stigma towards homeless children.

Inclusive education is carried out in all educational institutions at all levels of education. Based on the needs, both the learning process and the environment are adjusted to special educational needs. For example, at higher education level, the legislation in force envisions the appropriate support services for university entrants with disabilities so that they can participate in the Unified National Examinations on equal terms with other students, following the principle of reasonable accommodation. LEPL National Assessment and Examinations Center is entrusted to conduct the Unified National Examinations. One of the main priorities is to create equal conditions for all examinees. The center is committed to fulfil the promise of "exams for all" and every year hundreds of examinees with special needs pass various exams under the administration of the center. Among them are people with a wide range of conditions including blindness, hearing impairment, cerebral palsy and conditions causing limited motor functions. The Center ensures that the necessary special conditions are created in the examination centers.

The National Curriculum at all levels of education in various subjects provides students with the opportunity to comprehend and apply such concepts in various contexts as: rule of law, transparency, equality, non-discrimination, human rights and others. Introduction to these concepts commences at the primary level with the subject "I and Society" (grades III-IV), followed by "Our Georgia" (grades V-VI), and at the intermediate level, the subject "Citizenship" is taught as an independent course from grades VII to XII.

National Center for Teacher Professional Development (TPDC) under MoESY participates in the development of teacher professional development policies, implements professional development programs. TPDC aims to establish education as a core value while protecting children's rights and ensuring access to quality education, alongside with enhancing human rights teaching in schools. To achieve this, TPDC :

1. Is actively involved in promoting implementation of the Council of Europe's "Reference Framework of Competences for Democratic Culture", which is a tool to implement Human Rights Education. In 2018 state program "Democratic Culture and Human Rights Education at Schools," was launched. The given program aims to promote competences for democratic culture in schools through professional development of teachers, to provide the educational process oriented on human rights education, prevention of discrimination and development of safe and tolerant learning environment, to equip teachers and the school community with appropriate knowledge, skills and resources.

Within the framework of the program, the cooperation with various organizations at the local or international level and the Council of Europe and the European Union is in progress. Council of Europe has developed a platform Democratic Schools Network, where school projects are presented on a dedicated webpage so thousands of education practitioners across Europe can learn about it and Georgian schools also became a member of the Democratic Schools Network.

2. Provides teachers with training modules that address issues of human and children's rights, violence against children, discrimination. Teachers on their part, are able to transfer and use the acquired knowledge/information in the classroom the following number of teachers participated in trainings, where human and children rights were discussed:

- Training modul: "**Competencies of Democratic Culture**" (online format)- 689 teachers were trained in 2021 ;
- Training module: "**General Course for Civic Education Teachers**"- 65 teachers were trained in 2021 ;
- Training module: "**Teaching Peace - Peace Processes**", the following number of teachers were trained :
 - 521 teachers in 2021 ;
 - 102 teachers in 2022 ;
 - 276 teachers in 2023;
- Training module: "**Overcoming Violence against Children, INSPAIR strategies**", the following number of teachers were trained:
 - 249 teachers in 2022;
 - 364 teachers in 2023.
- Training-module : „**Sexual and Reproductive Health for Teachers**" on the Edx platform. 25 teachers were trained in 2023.
- Training module: "**Preventing Bullying in Schools and Promoting the Development of a Tolerant Culture**" –13320 teachers were trained on the Open Edx platform in 2023
- Training module "**Discrimination, Racism, Modern Challenges and Approaches in Education**", 26 teachers were trained in 2022.

In order to increase access to **vocational education** for persons with special educational needs and persons with disabilities, an alternative approach of enrolment has been developed since 2013. Various types of services are available: an inclusive vocational education specialist, learning process assistant, individual assistant, sign-language interpreter, orientation and mobility specialist. Adapted learning materials, individual study plans, transportation and more are constantly provided.

Since 2013 studying in state VET institutions is fully financed by the state, and since 2019 in private VET institutions in accordance with the priorities determined by the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia. Since 2017, VET students with special needs and disabilities are provided by the state with additional funding in the amount of 1000.0 GEL on a quarterly voucher. The VET institutions are fully adapted, educational resources were developed, such as the electronic bank of Georgian sign-language (which is located on a special web page) and the

mobile application of the mentioned bank, audio versions of vocational textbooks, guidelines related to vocational education were prepared. Furthermore, assistive technical devices such as portable video magnifiers, braille displays are available. Professional development of teachers and specialists involved in inclusive vocational education is carried out.

The new regulation of providing inclusive vocational education has been developed aimed at supporting principles of inclusiveness and ensures involvement of persons with disabilities and special education needs in VET. It also considers provision of orientation service for persons with special educational needs, which will help beneficiaries to make informed decision regarding future career pathway through practical testing of different elements of profession, throughout the year.

In 2021, a unified rule of enrolment in educational institutions was introduced in the vocational education system (The Order of the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia 42/n adopted in July 2, 2021 "On the approval of the rules and conditions of enrolment in the professional educational program"), according to which, in 2021, for the first time it became possible to enrol VET students with unified enrolment procedures not only in public but in all private institutions. 15% of the announced places are offered to the people with special needs. The admission process uses a variety of mechanisms, which, depending on the specifics of the program, provide a much more flexible approach to student selection. Registration of applicants is carried out online, the multidisciplinary team provides an assessment of the applicant and prepares of a relevant report, which will be reflected in the EMIS database. After the confirmation of the status, the selection of the person will be conducted based on a practical testing, which involves the practical performance of the activity/activities most characterizing the program by a person in conditions adapted to his/her individual needs and abilities.

Skills Agency established jointly by Chamber of Commerce and MoESY developed Career Guidance Service for persons with special educational needs and disabilities. The purpose of the service is to facilitate, on the one hand, the transition of persons with SEN and Disabilities to the level of vocational education, and on the other hand, to support them in the process of choosing a profession. To implement the service, methodological resources were developed and college staff have been trained.

Recently vocational education teachers' inclusion and gender mainstreaming standard has been created, which is a constituent part of the developed standards and represents the main determining regulatory framework of the teacher's work and its main goal is to develop practical skills and relevant attitudes among teachers for planning and implementing an inclusive and gender-sensitive learning process. According to the enrollment rule non-Georgian-speaking applicants have the opportunity to enroll in a professional educational program by passing the selection procedures (written test and/or interviews) in Armenian, Azerbaijani or Russian languages and choose a professional institution implementing professional educational programs with state funding. However, before enrolling at a specific field of VET programs, the applicant will be placed to take a 6-month long Georgian Language course and then, upon successful completion of this course, proceed studies to a VET program, accordingly.

People who received secondary education in the occupied territories of Georgia, can enroll in the vocational educational programs without passing the tests.

Enrolment procedures is differentiated adjusted to socially vulnerable people as well. Education management and information system generates the ranked list of applicants,

considering the results of the applicant assessment, the status of the person in the unified database of socially disadvantaged families and the achieved level of education.

Higher education institutions in Georgia are required by law to work in compliance with the internal and external quality assurance standards. The authorization standards of higher educational institutions in unity aim to create an environment in a higher educational institution that provides equal opportunities for beneficiaries involved in educational and research processes.

Nowadays, Georgia's system of external quality assurance comprises of institutional authorization and programme accreditation, while internal quality has functions on both institutional and programme levels to ensure the continuous evaluation and development of the quality of teaching, learning and research processes, professional development of staff and quality of the services and facilities provided by the institution.

Authorization of HEIs is an external mechanism of higher education quality assurance, which is carried out by the NCEQE. Authorization is an institutional evaluation, which determines compliance of an institution with the authorization standards. The evaluation process is carried out by expert panel and is based on the analysis of the information provided in the self-evaluation report (SER) of the institution and collected during the site-visit. Authorization is obligatory for all HEIs in order to be allowed to carry out educational activities and issue a diploma that is recognized by the state.

Accreditation of higher education programmes is an external mechanism of higher education quality assurance, which is carried out by the NCEQE. Accreditation is a programme evaluation, which determines compliance of a programme with the accreditation standards. The evaluation is carried out by the accreditation experts' panel including with international expert and is based on the analysis of the information indicated in the self-evaluation report of the programme and collected during the experts' site-visit. Accreditation is obligatory for all types and stages of programmes.

LEPL National Centre for Educational Quality Enhancement (NCEQE) under the Ministry has developed quality assurance standards in general, vocational and higher education and undertakes external quality evaluations that establishes and encourages minimum standards and norms in education.

The NCEQE has considered conditions relating to the quality of education in its higher education quality assurance standards. Evaluation of infrastructure is a part of a Standard 7 -Material, information and financial resources. It considers to evaluate infrastructure and its safety for students and staff, environment necessary for implementing educational activities and adapted environment for people with special needs. Teaching materials are also evaluated within standard 7, in material resources.

In accordance with the requirements of the authorization standards, Students with special educational needs should have access to learning resources considered by a programme or individual teaching plan, that are adapted to their needs and demands; To achieve this, the institution provides appropriate forms and conditions for teaching and learning, taking into account special educational needs and academic preparation. The institution should submit individualized education programmes and methodology for their development.

People with special needs should be able to freely navigate and move around the building (including, ramps, elevators, etc.); Specially adapted sanitary unit should be in place for

students with special needs; The institution provides adapted environment and/or further development plan.

Evaluation of learner/teacher ratios is a part of a Standard 4 - Staff of the HEI. It considers to evaluate ratios at institutions to evaluate staff workload and therefore quality of program implementations within workloads and ratios.

Use of ICT has a crucial part in evaluation standards, it is evaluated in Standard 7 as a part of information resources infrastructure, also it is evaluated in standard 2, as it is considered to be a part of effective management of the institution.

The Office of the Resource Officers operating under the MoESY is responsible for a harmonized and safe climate in schools, where the relationships are based on respect and equality, the emotional needs of students are considered and the rights of all the humans involved in the learning process are protected.

In 2019, Human Rights Education programme has been developed for the Office of the Resource Officers of Educational Institutions by CoE experts. As a result, more than 1300 School Resource Officers, psychologists and social workers are trained in human rights education within the framework of the CoE projects.

☒ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☒ In primary education

☒ In secondary education

☒ In technical and vocational education and training

☐ In higher education

☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

In 2023, the revised **State Standards for Early and Preschool Care and Education** reflect the changes that strengthen non-discriminatory care and education and develop appropriate environments and staff qualifications (<https://matsne.gov.ge/ka/document/view/5874497?publication=0>). Changes include the following directions and standards:

Welfare - creating a religious indoctrination-free environment and proselytism (Standard 1.5); emotional safety for ethnic minority children (1.2.9 and 1.2.10);

Curriculum and methodology - teaching the Georgian language in bilingual groups (2.1.6); The possibility of sharing information and knowledge in their native language for children whose native language is not Georgian (2.3.7);

Physical environment standard - indicators cover universal design principles in the environment arrangement (3.1.10; 3.1.11; 3.1.12.) following the needs of children with special educational needs and equipment of groups in non-Georgian-speaking institutions (3.3.10); New indicator on issues of arranging additional spaces considering the children with special educational needs (3.1.5; 3.1.6.);

Communication - positive relationship with peers: (4.1.3; 4.1.4; 4.1.7; 4.1.12; 4.1.13; 4.1.14.) Provision of an inclusive environment to include a child with special educational needs in the educational process and promote positive relationships with peers; a new indicator (4.3.5) support for families of linguistic minorities, the importance of providing information in a language they understand;

Educational process 5.1 - The educational staff draws on the universal design principles during the educational process, considering respective indicators. The new indicator (5.3.5) refers to the necessity of assessing the additional needs of the educator to implement individual approaches. The 12 new standard (5.6) indicators address the needs of children with disabilities about individual goals, plans, and processes (5.6.1; 5.6.2; 5.6.3; 5.6.4; 5.6.5; 5.6.6; 5.6.7; 5.6.8; 5.6.10; 5.6.12).

Standard 5.7 - Educational staff takes care of personal and professional development. The staff must independently assess needs and the need to own assistive technologies for working with children with disabilities (5.7.4; 5.7.5).

The National Curriculum at all levels of general education (primary, lower-secondary and upper-secondary) in various subjects provides students with the opportunity to comprehend and apply such concepts in various contexts as: rule of law, transparency, equality, non-discrimination, human rights and others. Introduction to these concepts commences at the primary level with the subject "I and Society" (grades III-IV), followed by "Our Georgia" (grades V-VI), and at the intermediate level, the subject "Citizenship" is taught as an independent course from grades VII to XII.

Vocational education contributes to the development of the necessary competencies through which citizens act in society with appropriate responsibility, as well as in accordance with such values as equality, dignity, social responsibility, and etc.

In Georgia, the institutional practice of introducing key competencies of vocational and training education has been going on step by step in recent years, especially the component of strengthening general modules. In 2020, the stand-alone Civil Education module was revised, which reflects the important learning outcomes such as the understanding of basic human rights and their protection mechanisms. The learning outcome topics include:

Human Rights:

- Classification of human rights
- Division of human rights into generations

Civil Rights:

- Right to life, honour, and dignity
- Inviolability and respect for private life
- Freedom of movement and the right to choose a place of residence
- Protection of rights through the courts

Political Rights:

- The right to participate in state affairs
- Freedom of speech
- The right to participate in demonstrations and gatherings
- The right to association

Socio-Economic and Cultural Rights:

- The right to work
- The right to education
- Social and cultural diversity

Collective (Solidarity) Rights:

- The right to live in an ecologically clean environment
- Rights of ethnic minorities

Human Rights Protection Mechanisms at the National Level:

- Judicial system of Georgia
- Public Defender
- Department of Gender Equality
- Prevention of violence against women and/or domestic violence
- Tolerance Center

International Mechanisms for the Protection of Human Rights:

- European Court of Human Rights

☒ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

Evaluation of school textbooks is carried out by content criteria, which includes the following types of criteria along with field ones:

1. Content of the textbook (subject/sectoral content) is accurate and objective
 - The content (text/visual material) is reliable and accurate. The content is in line with modern achievements of the field: terms, concepts, facts, events, processes are provided correctly.
 - The information is objective. An author of the textbook does not influence the reader with his/her attitudes and subjective sentiments and beliefs.
2. Protection of equality, Prohibition of discrimination and discrediting elements
 - Textbook is free of stereotypical, incorrect, discriminatory and/or discrediting elements of race, colour, sex, origin, ethnicity, language, religion, political or other views, social affiliation, etc.
 - Depending on the specifics of subject, the equality of nationality, religion, gender, social belonging, etc. are protected in the texts and illustrations
3. Protection ethic standards
 - Textbook is free of obscene and inaccurate expressions. If primary source contains such an expression, the appropriate text is provided in an adapted form.
4. Prohibition violence and enmity:
The illustrations and content are free:
 - of any incitement to violence, including vandalism and harmful acts against a living and non-living nature;
 - of texts and illustrations provoking national, regional, religious or social hostility.
5. Relevance to the constitution of Georgia
 - Content (texts, visual materials, exercises, tasks) of the textbook does not contradict the Constitution of Georgia.

In addition, at the evaluation stage, along with specialists in the field, there is also a representative of the human rights defender in the evaluation commission, which is a guarantee of minimizing the anti-discriminatory nature of the content of the educational resources.

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (*several items may be ticked*):

General measures:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all | ☒ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ¹⁷ are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all | ☒ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design ¹⁸ |
| ☒ Teachers are trained on inclusive education ¹⁶ and to value diversity | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported |
| ☒ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance | |
| ☒ Other: | |

The ORO specialists regularly carry out informative, educational and social-skill development activities, using evidence-based materials and resources for school students, teachers, parents and school representatives on human rights, equality, diversity, hate speech, non-discriminatory approach and harmful practices.

Vocational student's selection procedures are tailored to the needs of vulnerable groups. Persons with special educational needs go through simplified process and do not pass selection stages defined for general stream of applicants.

Flexible and needs-based selection procedures are also in place for representatives of ethnic minority groups as well, who, in addition to the basic services, attend Georgian language course, which is fully funded by the state.

Enrolment procedures is differentiated adjusted to socially vulnerable people as well. Moreover, people who received secondary education in the occupied territories of Georgia, can enrol in the vocational educational programs without passing the tests. (*please see the information above*).

¹⁶ Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper](#): Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

¹⁷ Multiple and flexible learning pathways are 'entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education' ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

¹⁸ In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Please see the question 1.1

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for gender equality in education | ☒ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality | ☐ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for |
| ☒ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken | ☒ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities ²⁰ |
| ☒ Providing positive or affirmative action measures | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²¹ and bias |
| ☐ Providing financial incentives and fellowships | ☐ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ¹⁹ | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

2022-2030 Unified National Strategy of Education and Science of Georgia was adopted on the 31st of August by the Governmental Decree N446. The Strategy dwells on three main pillars of Equity, Quality and Governance and adheres to the principles of equality, inclusion and diversity. 2022-2024 Action Plan of the Strategy encompasses multiple activities focusing on the gender equality:

- Conducting awareness-raising campaigns on the importance of early and preschool education services, including gender equality issues
- Analysis of gender equality issues in the field of vocational education

¹⁹ ‘ Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them’ (Cambridge Dictionary).

²⁰ ‘ Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal’ ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

²¹ Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong’ (Cambridge Dictionary).

- Supporting HEIs (Higher Education Institutions) in developing and implementing gender equality policy documents/mechanisms
- Developing a resource allocation mechanism for research and innovation, considering the gender equality principle
- Creating a digital platform for career planning and empowerment of girls/women in STEM fields

The Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia strives to integrate **gender mainstreaming** in its policy documents. The recommendations of international or local organizations and partners concerning the gender equality are taken into account. The Ministry works closely with partners and field specialists to integrate the best practices of different countries in Georgian education system.

A **Gender Mainstreaming Platform** was created in the Ministry within the framework of the Memorandum signed between the Ministry and UN Women in 2022, to strengthen gender mainstreaming in the education system, to eliminate gender stereotypes, as well as to raise the sensitivity of teachers and schoolchildren to issues of gender equality.

Additionally, a **participatory gender audit** (PGA) was conducted within the system of the Ministry of Education and Science by UN Women to identify issues for improvement and assess progress in a number of directions of gender equality in the sector.

Issues of gender, citizenship and equality and equality are given special attention in the national curriculum, and it is in the context of the discussion, analysis and understanding of the national curriculum that the relevant educational programs focus on these issues.

Issues related to gender stereotypes are reflected in the **National Curriculum** of Georgia, namely in the social sciences group standards. Besides, the mentioned issue is considered in the textbooks. The evaluation criteria for textbooks, in particular, the group of criteria - "compliance with legal and ethical norms" provides for the protection of equality, the prohibition of discrimination and discrediting elements (The textbook must be free from stereotyped, incorrect, discriminatory and/or discrediting elements based on language, nationality, religion, gender, social affiliation and other grounds);

There is no need for special re-entry programs at the level of general education. The system is open. The school entry age is 6 years, and there is no upper limit. Nor are there any other barriers to schooling. It is also possible to complete the studies with external exams.

Issues of **early marriage** and gender equality are discussed in the following TPDC training modules:

1. In 2021, the training module "Gender Mainstreaming in Education: Gender-based violence and Domestic violence" was developed with the joint cooperation of the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia, National Center for Teacher Professional Development and UN WOMEN. The training module covers gender issues: Violence against women and girls, domestic violence, discrimination in the workplace, salary, etc. cases of the impact of stereotypes, stigmas and preconceived notions, discussion of the practice of sexual harassment in the workplace, discrimination based on heritage, human trafficking, discussing cases of rape of minors, marriage of children under 18, femicide.

The training module is designed for teachers of all subjects of general education schools. 1231 teachers were trained in 2022.

2. Early marriage issues are discussed in the training module: "**Overcoming Violence Against Children, INSPAIR Strategies**", attended by:

- 249 trainees in 2022.
- 364 trainees in 2023.

3. Sexual and reproductive health issues are covered in the training course "**Sexual and Reproductive Health for Teachers**", which is uploaded on the Edx platform. 25 participants, teachers of different subjects, completed the course in 2023.

All relevant policy documents developed in **VET system** in recent years, are gender mainstreamed, including the draft vocational education strategy for 2024-2030; Career guidance strategy Regulatory framework for Vocational education teachers' professional development, standards, remuneration, code of ethics; Draft document of Inclusive vocational education concept;

A manual, "Gender mainstreaming in a vocational educational institution", was developed to support VET institutions to integrate gender issues in all areas of the school policy and activities. The guide was prepared within the framework of the USAID-financed project "Integrating gender equality and equal opportunities in regional vocational education institutions", implemented by the Georgian Institute of Public Affairs (GIPA).

Based on the newly developed VET teacher's standards, one of which is focused on gender and inclusion, as part of the teachers in-service and pre-service programmes, is being developed comprehensive training modules covering inclusive and gender sensitive teaching and learning in VET.

Hub Colleges Prestige and Iberia are developing a sexual harassment prevention and response mechanism aimed at creating a safe environment free from sexual violence and discrimination.

In hub colleges gender segregated statistical data was analyzed, the respective recommendations were developed on how to develop more gender sensitive and socially adjusted strategies and services in the institution. Based on the recommendations both colleges' management updated college strategies and action plans and carried out gender sensitive awareness raising and information campaigns to attract potential students, especially women and girls in VET.

Higher educational institutions have implemented a number of activities within their autonomy, in particular, issues of gender discrimination are reflected in the educational programs, modules and training courses of different higher educational institutions of Georgia, both private and public.

For additional information please see the question 1.1

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

In some regions of Georgia, public acceptance of gender equality and stigmatization is still at a less degree. Thus, teacher trainings and other professional development services are crucial in tackling the issue.

Low gender sensitivity and insufficient competences of employees in VET institutions regarding gender equality issues.

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) ²²:

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

National minorities:

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities | ☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁴ |
| ☒ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☒ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities | ☒ Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities |
| ☒ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities | ☒ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁵ and bias |

²² Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: "a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition."

²⁴ Supra note 15.

²⁵ Supra note 16.

☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities

☒ Other²³:

The National Center for Teacher Professional Development (TPDC) implements the "Non-Georgian Language Schools Support " program, the purpose of which is to support the professional development of teachers of non-Georgian language schools in regions densely populated by national minorities; Within the framework of the program, 145 consultant-teachers are currently assigned to the above-mentioned regions (Samtskhe-Javakheti, Kvemo Kartli and Kakheti). TPDC carries out the following activities to enhance the state language knowledge among the teachers of non-Georgian-language schools:

- Offers state language training course to teachers;
- Offers non-formal activities to students on project-based learning, club work and Sunday schools for ethnic minority school students

Since 2016 non-Georgian-speaking applicants to VET institutions have the opportunity to undertake selection procedures in Armenian, Russian and Azerbaijani languages. After enrollment, they are offered a Georgian language learning module, upon successful completion of which, they are given the opportunity to continue their studies at the desired VET program. Currently, the process of development of new state language program in VET is underway and after its implementation, the vocational education system will provide new program for learning the state language for non-Georgian language applicants, including ethnic minorities.

"1+4 Program" is a **higher education** opportunity for ethnic minorities available as an accredited, special one-year preparatory program in Georgian language. Beneficiaries of the Program are financed for one-year language course and Bachelor studies for the duration of the educational program in authorized higher educational institutions.

University entrants are entitled to pursue their studies on the mentioned program, if they pass one of the following tests in Unified National Examinations:

- Azerbaijani-language general skills test;
- Armenian-language general skills test;
- Ossetian-language test;
- Abkhazian-language test.

Since 2023, in order to promote higher education in Roma, MoESY is financing studies at the bachelor's level for Roma students within the framework of the student financing social program, (Decree of the Government of Georgia, #324, 18/08/2023). In 2023, 1 Roma student submitted an application, who was awarded a state grant for the duration of her educational program.

LEPL Zurab Zhvania School of Public Administration operating under the MoESY provides Georgian language courses at no cost for the representatives of national minorities employed in the public sector, local self-government bodies, regional administrations, the resource centres of the Ministry of Education, Science and Youth employees of public schools, teachers and all other stakeholders through 12 Training Centres, mobile groups and online format teaching. The School, within the State Language Teaching and Integration Programme, provides 25 State language training courses for improving general competencies in Georgian

language proficiency, complying with the European language competency levels (Beginners Georgian (A1.1 A1.2), Basic Georgian (A2.1, A2.2), General Georgian (B1.1, B1.2), Alphabetic Georgian, Communication Georgian), as well as 17 professional courses saturated with sectoral vocabulary, that helps the beneficiaries not only to advance the language skills, but to better integrate in the respective professional field, which, among others, includes Support Course for Teachers (I and II course). In 2021-2024 (as of 1 June 2024), 5410 teachers and pedagogues of various subjects of non-Georgian public schools were involved in various state language courses.

For additional information Please see the question 1.1

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Proficiency in the state language, for better integration in the society.

Indigenous people:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁶ |
| ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people | ☐ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people | ☐ Native language instruction is ensured |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people | ☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁷ and bias |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

²⁶ Supra note 15.

²⁷ Supra note 16.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations²⁸:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☒ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ³¹ are provided |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³² and bias |
| ☒ All administrative barriers to access education are removed | ☐ Accelerated learning programmes are provided |
| ☒ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers ²⁹ are provided for | ☒ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided |
| ☐ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion | ☒ Language classes to newcomers are provided for |
| ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³⁰ | ☐ Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged |
| ☒ Other: | |

According to the Law of Georgia "On General Education", the Ministry of Education, Science and Youth of Georgia ensures the openness of general education in public schools and its equal access to everyone throughout life.

According to Article 22 of the same law, the state ensures provision of full general education. The state funding of the student's education in the general educational institution continues for 12 years. The financing of a full general education applies to a citizen of Georgia, to a person with a temporary identification card, to a person provided for in Article 2013 of the Law of Georgia "On the Procedure for Issuing Registration, Identity (Residence) Certificates and Passports of Georgian Citizens and Foreigners Living in Georgia", to foreign nationals (including citizens of other countries with compatriot status living abroad), stateless persons, and persons with international protection.

²⁸ 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

²⁹ While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

³⁰ Supra note 15.

³¹ Supra note 13

³² Supra note 16.

Ukrainian-language sectors are operational in Tbilisi Public School N41, Tbilisi Public School N220 and Batumi Public School N20. The curriculum offered to the students in Georgia, is compatible and corresponds to the educational system of both Georgia and Ukraine. In addition, to the subjects envisaged within the Ukrainian-language sectors curricula, Ukrainian students are offered Georgian language and history classes. According to the decision of the Government of Georgia, Ukrainian students are enrolled in Georgian schools in a simplified manner.

Currently there are more than 2059 students from Ukraine in general education institutions of Georgia. 1262 students are enrolled in Ukrainian sectors.

In case of **asylum seekers**, there is no different regulation for enrollment in schools. The only difference is that the parent or legal representative has to submit a copy of the residence document in Georgia together with other required documents.

Asylum seeker students are enrolled in public/private schools in accordance with the order N04/n of the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia (January 11, 2017). They also receive voucher funding.

There is no different regulation for enrollment in schools. The only difference is that the parent or legal representative has to submit a copy of the residence document in Georgia together with other required documents.

To ensure access to general education for asylum seekers and persons with international protection in Georgia and the possibility of general education for under-aged people placed in the temporary placement centers of the Migration Department of the Ministry of Internal Affairs of Georgia, the package of the educational program for training in the Georgian language within the framework of the general education promotion sub-program includes the teaching of the Georgian language according to the A1 and A2 levels.

In addition to language lessons, the program includes the use of elements of art, sports, and music in order to strengthen the language teaching component. If necessary, the program can be implemented with a remote electronic synchronous model using different electronic platforms. The implementation of the educational program of training in the Georgian language is provided by public school N23 of Tbilisi named after Ilia Chavchavadze and N2 public schools of the village Martkopi, Gardabani municipality.

Evaluation of school textbooks is carried out by content criteria, which includes the following types of criteria along with field ones:

6. Content of the textbook (subject/sectoral content) is accurate and objective
 - The content (text/visual material) is reliable and accurate. The content is in line with modern achievements of the field: terms, concepts, facts, events, processes are provided correctly.
 - The information is objective. An author of the textbook does not influence the reader with his/her attitudes and subjective sentiments and beliefs.
7. Protection of equality, Prohibition of discrimination and discrediting elements
 - Textbook is free of stereotypical, incorrect, discriminatory and/or discrediting elements of race, colour, sex, origin, ethnicity, language, religion, political or other views, social affiliation, etc.

- Depending on the specifics of subject, the equality of nationality, religion, gender, social belonging, etc. are protected in the texts and illustrations
8. Protection ethic standards
 - Textbook is free of obscene and inaccurate expressions. If primary source contains such an expression, the appropriate text is provided in an adapted form.
 9. Prohibition violence and enmity:

The illustrations and content are free:

 - of any incitement to violence, including vandalism and harmful acts against a living and non-living nature;
 - of texts and illustrations provoking national, regional, religious or social hostility.
 10. Relevance to the constitution of Georgia
 - Content (texts, visual materials, exercises, tasks) of the textbook does not contradict the Constitution of Georgia.

In addition, at the evaluation stage, along with specialists in the field, there is also a representative of the human rights defender in the evaluation commission, which is a guarantee of minimizing the anti-discriminatory nature of the content of the educational resources.

The National Center for Teacher Professional Development (TPDC) in collaboration with NE (NC) Gudavadze - Patarkatsishvili Foundation, the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) and World Vision Georgia Foundation is implementing the project "Supporting access to state language education for refugee students living in Georgia".

The project provides online Georgian language classes twice a week for asylum-seeking school students. At this stage, 10 students are involved. Working groups are also developing a curriculum and textbook for Georgian as a foreign language.

State fully finances studies in public **Vocational educational** institutions and in private vocational institutions in accordance with the priority areas determined by the minister not only to Georgian citizens, as well as to foreign citizens with the status of compatriot living abroad, asylum seekers, persons with refugee or humanitarian status and to the individuals who has the status of stateless person in Georgia and who is or was under state care (in foster care, small family-type homes, shelters, etc.).

VET is open to any person regardless their citizenship. As for the refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons, they can study for free at state-sponsored programs.

Access to Higher Education

20% of state education grants are annually allocated for the social grants program. Needs-based grants are awarded to students with different social background: students from highland areas; graduates from minority schools (Azerbaijani and Armenian); students from families of the militaries Killed in Actions and Missing in Actions; repatriates; orphans and students from large families, students under the state care; students affected by Russian aggression; students from the occupied territories; students with special education needs/disabilities; socially vulnerable students.

Since 2017, Zurab Zhvania School of Public Administration has been teaching the Georgian language to asylum seekers and persons granted international protection in Georgia in Martkopi Asylum Seekers Reception Centre and Integration Centre as well as through mobile groups. In 2021-2024 (as of 1 June 2024), 43 asylum seekers underwent Georgian language courses of the

Georgian Language Teaching and Integration Programme at Martkopi Reception Centre, while 332 persons with international protection benefited from the mentioned programme. Due to a significant influx of Ukrainian citizens to Georgia as a result of the ongoing war waged by Russia against Ukraine, since 2022, together with the Ministry of Education, Science and Youth of Georgia, the decision was made to make the School's state language programs available to Ukrainian citizens living in Georgia as the high interest and demand was observed. Since then, 1201 Ukrainian citizens have enrolled in Georgian language courses at ZSPA.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People with disabilities:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☒ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³³ |
| ☒ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☒ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☒ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools | ☒ Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³⁴ and bias |
| ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided | ☒ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted |
| ☒ Other | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

³³ Supra note 15.

³⁴ Supra note 16.

Since 2005 the Ministry started to develop **Inclusive Education** at General Education level. Law on General Education and National Curriculum recognize the individual and alternative forms of Education. For accessible and quality education developed additional services for SENs in Public schools.

In Georgia special education needs (SEN) of a pupil is based on the assessment and conclusion of the multidisciplinary team. A multidisciplinary team was created, which consists of 50 members and covers the whole Georgia. The team consists of different specialists (psychologist, special teacher, occupational therapist, psychiatrist), whose function is to determine special educational needs (SEN) in accordance with standardized tests and develop recommendations for schools in teaching and learning.

The procedure for the introduction, development and monitoring of inclusive education were approved as well as the mechanism for the identification of students with special educational needs. The mechanism regulated the progression of inclusive education in the school as well as the process of determining the status of SEN students by a multidisciplinary team. The additional specialists who should work with the SEN student were defined – psychologist, occupational therapist, speech therapist, sign language interpreter, sign language specialist, orientation and mobility specialist, assistant of a person with special educational needs.

The Ministry is developing numerous auxiliary resources, guides, manuals, which serve to promote the education of the SEN student and are intended for specialists, teachers, and parents. Alternative curricula are a part of the National Curriculum. If it is impossible for a SEN student to learn some of the subjects specified in the National Curriculum, the Alternative Curriculum is a document that includes and describes the standard of the subjects, the teaching recommendations, the means of achievement, the functional skills and the knowledge acquisition. According to the alternative curriculum, each subject is taught using a variety of learning strategies and gives the student functional and academic knowledge. Part of the National Curriculum is an alternative curriculum for students with severe and multiple mental disorders and autism spectrum disorders; Sensory curriculum for students with severe and multiple mental and physical development disorders; Advanced curriculum for students with visual impairments; Mobility-Orientation Standard. A standard for teaching Georgian sign language at the elementary level, a curriculum for lowering and accelerated learning for those who are left out of compulsory education. Textbooks are printed in Braille for visually impaired students, and audio versions of the textbooks are also prepared. The Ministry ensures purchase of technical equipment in order to support the education of visually impaired students. Furthermore, infrastructural projects are implemented, and educational institutions are adapted. The SEN students are provided with transportation services.

The Ministry has created electronic support tool for the Georgian Braille font in order to foster access to education for blind pupils/students. Electronic braille support tool is integrated into the open-source, free software “liblvi”, which is built into various screen readers such as NVDA, JAWS, and others. As a result, blind people can read information displayed on a computer screen using an electronic braille display. It has also become possible to type text using the Braille keyboard, which allows blind people to fully use computers both in study and working environments, as well as in everyday life.

Within the framework of the program "Provision of textbooks for students and teachers":

1. Students of I-XII grades are provided with school textbooks.
2. Braille and relief printing manuals and audio versions of manuals for blind and partially sighted students are provided, along with modern assistive devices (Portable video magnifier, mechanical braille, scanner with Georgian print optical (OCR) recognition, tactile drawing board with bracket, touch braille note-taker) designed for blind and partially sighted students.

Within the framework of the "Provision of Transportation for Public School Students" program ESIDA provides the transportation for children of Tbilisi public schools. Public school students, regardless of gender, ethnic origin, religion, can use the transport service if needed. It is worth noting that in Tbilisi, the purchase for children with special needs and disabilities is carried out separately, where different circumstances are considered, namely: if necessary, adapted transport is provided for children using wheelchairs. Also, a special accompanying person is present in the car during the transportation of disabled students.

In November 2023, an amendment was introduced to the Law of Georgia "On General Education", which, based on best Norwegian practice, creates the basis for the implementation of a new system supporting inclusive education in the Office of Resource Officers of Educational Institutions (ORO). The new model supporting inclusive education will enter into force from June 1, 2024. In the meantime, the process of setting up Inclusive and Special Education Support Center is underway at the Office of Resource Officers of Educational Institutions (ORO). The Center will coordinate the identification of special educational needs, counselling services, transition support processes, etc.

According to the **Authorization Standards** of General Education Institutions schools are obliged to fulfil the following requirements:

3.5.1.4. School infrastructure provides inclusive learning environment;

2.1.2.4. The learning process is inclusive and takes into account the differentiated approaches;

The National Center for Teacher Professional Development (TPDC) implements the "Inclusive Education Support" program. The program aims to promote access to education and create equal opportunities in preschool and general educational institutions. Its goal is to create an inclusive and equitable educational environment, where all students can thrive, regardless of their abilities, backgrounds, or circumstances.

In order to ensure the right of students with educational needs to quality education, the program offers an educational course called the "Special Education Teacher Professional Development Introductory Course". This course entails 5 modules:

- Theories of learning and development;
- Development, developmental disorders;
- Holistic assessment of the student (academic, cognitive, communicative, behavioral, and others);
- Individual curriculum and teaching-learning strategies;
- Management of a challenging behavior (Positive Behavior Interventions and Supports (PBIS)).

The purpose of the course is to provide in-depth professional development of special education teachers employed in the system. The course was attended by the following numbers of teachers:

Up to 600 special education teachers in 2021;
220 special education teachers in 2022;
224 special education teachers in 2023.

Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia started implementation of the **inclusive vocational education** within Georgia's vocational education system since 2013. To increase access to vocational education for persons with special educational needs and persons with disabilities, an alternative approach of enrolment has been developed since 2013. To support the learning process of VET students with special educational needs and disabilities various types of services

are available: an inclusive vocational education specialist, learning process assistant, individual assistant, sign-language interpreter, orientation and mobility specialist. Adapted learning materials, individual study plans, transportation and more are constantly provided.

Since 2013 studying in state VET institutions is fully financed by the state, and since 2019 in private VET institutions in accordance with the priorities determined by the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia. Since 2017, VET students with special needs and disabilities are provided by the state with additional funding in the amount of 1000.0 GEL on a quarterly voucher. The mentioned amount is used to provide services tailored to the individual needs of abovementioned students. The VET institutions are fully adapted, since the adapted environment of the institution is one of the important prerequisites for compliance with the authorization standards. To support the education of VET students with special needs, educational resources were developed, such as the electronic bank of Georgian sign-language (which is located on a special web page) and the mobile application of the mentioned bank, audio versions of vocational textbooks, guidelines related to vocational education were prepared. Furthermore, assistive technical devices such as portable video magnifiers, braille displays are available. Professional development of teachers and specialists involved in inclusive vocational education is carried out.

Since the establishment of the Skills agency in 2021, work on elaboration of additional services is ongoing by the MoES and the Agency, which is based on an analysis of VET delivery to the vulnerable groups including for the students with special educational needs.

In 2021-2022 the regulation of providing inclusive vocational education has been developed. The regulation aims supporting principles of inclusiveness and ensures involvement of persons with disabilities and special education needs in VET. It also considers provision of carrier orientation service for persons with special educational needs, which will help beneficiaries to make informed decision regarding future career pathway through practical testing of different elements of profession, throughout the year. Within the scope of the service, the interested person will have the opportunity to receive detailed information about the desired occupation, educational opportunities and labor market characteristics, and to practically try the activities typical to the occupation. This will allow them to make an informed occupational choice and support their transition to the level of vocational education.

In 2021, a unified rule of enrolment in educational institutions was introduced in the vocational education system (The Order of the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia 42/n adopted in July 2, 2021 "On the approval of the rules and conditions of enrolment in the professional educational program"), according to which, in 2021, for the first time it became possible to enrol VET students with unified enrolment procedures not only in public but in all private institutions. Thus, all authorized, including private institutions accept students only through a single admission, through a common platform. In accordance with the new enrolment rule 15% of the announced places are offered to the people with special needs, as a resulted up to 1500 places were offered to the people with special educational needs in 2022. The application process uses a variety of mechanisms, which, depending on the specifics of the program, provide a much more flexible approach to student selection. Those wishing to enrol in higher vocational education programs have to pass the test organized by the National Assessment and Examinations Center (NAEC). Following the completion of the selection procedures, the rule envisages formation of ranking lists of applicants, considering the relevant criteria for each program. Registration of applicants is carried out online, through registration on the portal - vet.emis.ge. Similar to other applicants, individuals with special educational needs and disabilities are given the opportunity to select 3 preferred programs, enhancing their chances of enrolment in any of the chosen programs. To confirm a special educational need, during online registration on the portal -

vet.emis.ge, the applicant must check the box "person with special educational needs" in the registration column. A member of the multidisciplinary team will contact a person with a disability status within approximately 5 working days of registration and provide an assessment of the applicant and the preparation of a relevant report, which will be reflected in the EMIS database. After the confirmation of the status, the selection of the person with special educational need will be conducted according to the rules established by the institutions, based on a practical testing. Practical testing involves the practical performance of the activity/activities most characterizing the program by a person in conditions adapted to his/her individual needs and abilities, which is accompanied by a reflection process and serves to better clarify the applicant's own abilities and professional interests, as well as to determine the strengths and weaknesses of a person in a specific occupation/program by observers. It is recommended that the applicant with special educational needs takes a practical testing in all programs selected during the registration. If the person is not registered during the admission procedure as the person with special educational needs and is enrolled as the person with typical ability and has some kind physical restriction, has the opportunity to apply to the VET institution after the enrolment and introduce the report of multidisciplinary team and the document confirming its limited capability (issued by the Ministry of Internally Displaced Persons from the Occupied Territories, Labour, Health and Social Affairs of Georgia). After applying the status of the person is reflected in the EMIS data base and the above-mentioned additional funding in the amount of 1000.0 GEL is available for him/her for the supportive services.

The standards for the **authorization of vocational educational institutions** include indicators according to which the institution must have an adapted environment (including sanitary units) and adapted learning resources in accordance with the needs and requirements of persons with disabilities. Also, the institution will develop and implement individual study plans with the involvement of persons of special needs and taking into account their interests, in accordance with the applicable legislation.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

1. **Challenge:** Insufficient number of qualified special education teachers in the mountainous and remote villages of Georgia, where special education needs students are enrolled.
2. **Challenge:** There is no professional regulation and career advancement scheme for psychologists in the general education system.
3. **Challenge:** Integrating the component of social and emotional learning into educational practice, enhancing the competencies of teachers and inclusive education support specialists in social-emotional learning.

Students from poor households:

☐ Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided

☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁵

☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³⁶ and bias

³⁵ Supra note 15.

³⁶ Supra note 16.

- ☐ Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education
- ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided
- ☐ Other:

All public-school students are provided with **school textbooks** free of charge by the state. Uniforms are not required in public schools.

Article 14 of the Law of Georgia "On General Education" defines:

6. School has the right to introduce/set the school uniform in a way that does not restrict the freedom of expression of a student and a teacher. The student and the teacher have the right to refuse to wear the school uniform.

7. When introducing a school uniform, a school shall consider the student's financial background, and if they are unable to purchase a uniform, the school shall provide them with a uniform.

The Social Service Agency and local municipalities have targeted financial assistance allocated to help vulnerable families with children, including for providing school supplies.

There is a school in every settlement of Georgia. If there is no school near the home for a child, the state provides transportation service to students to the nearest school free of charge.

According to the national curriculum, the maximum number of students in a class in a public school is determined by 25 students (Order N40/n of the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia dated May 18, 2016; Article 9, Clause 18).

Enrolment procedures is differentiated adjusted to socially vulnerable people. Education management and information system generates the ranked list of applicants, considering the results of the applicant assessment, the status of the person in the unified database of socially disadvantaged families and the achieved level of education. If the applicant is a person receiving subsistence allowance in the unified database of socially vulnerable families, his/her rating score is determined by multiplying received evaluation scores to 1.1. coefficient, which is specially designated to this target group

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation³⁷ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education³⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free
- ☒ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable
- ☒ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis
- ☒ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play.

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

To ensure quality of ECCE services in Georgia, ECEC reform started in 2022. Several important amendments initiated into the law of “Early and preschool Education and care” and the process came into force.

According to the Decree N337 of June 24, 2022 of the Government of Georgia “On Approval of the rules of procedure for operation of the electronic system for initial registration of the institution providing early childhood education and care services and/or preschool education and/or education service and/or the school readiness program”, the education management information system under the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia created electronic system where all providers have been registered:

Number of Kindergarten			
Kindergarten Type / year	2022	2023	2024 (march 12)
Private Kindergarten	323	310	292
Public Kindergarten	1704	1737	1737
Total	2027	2047	2029

According to the changes, authorization process of kindergartens within a transitional period of time was handed over to the central government, namely to the LEPL National Center for Educational Quality Enhancement under the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia. The amended law laid down core activities to be implemented and set up the authorization schedule. Under the requirement of the revised law, the authorization

³⁷ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.
³⁸ Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

standards and temporary rule for authorization were approved by the Government of Georgia. The Decree N76 of February 21, 2023 of the Government of Georgia "On the approval of the temporary rule for the authorization of the early education and/or preschool education institution, as well as the suspension and termination of the institution's authorization" defines the quality assurance framework. The decree ensures equal terms and standards to all service providers and determine Authorization standards of ECEC Institutions (kindergartens):

- a) Mission and Strategic Development of the Institution;
- b) Curriculum; (The curriculum is based on play and considers the child as an active participant in his own learning and development).
- c) Family and Community Involvement;
- d) Supporting the Process of Education and Care (including Personnel management and development, Material resources, Food organization and rations, Sanitary-hygiene norms, Physical and emotional security and Financial resources).

The participation of young children in preschool and kindergarten education increased significantly between 2005 and 2018, from 45% in 2005 to 78% in 2018. (By 2021-2022), 72.3% of preschool children went to kindergarten.

The growth rate is higher for 3-year-olds. The change in the participation rate is particularly visible for children living in rural areas: the participation rate increased by 17% in urban areas and by 43% in rural areas.

One of the main reasons for this indicator is that from September 1, 2013, it was prohibited to introduce taxes, tariffs or other fees in public preschool institutions.

(Thematic research report. Committee on Education, Science and Youth of the Parliament of Georgia).

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

- ☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

- ☒ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.

- ☒ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:

Pre-primary education is free of charge for Georgia citizens, migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs or for children with permanent residence permission.

In accordance to the Georgian law on early and preschool education and care, free ECCE service, including nutrition, is mandatory in public institutions, for all children of relevant age. Public service providers are established by local government. Besides, private sector provides service from age 0 until school age.

- ☐ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Law of Georgia on Early and Preschool Education

Article 4- The principles of preschool education

1. The children of Georgia at the public preschool education institutions of Georgia are ensured free education and catering services as provided for by the legislation of Georgia .

2. Preschool education, including the school readiness programme, is voluntary, universal and available for every child of relevant age.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

☒ Limited access

☐ Poor learning outcomes

☒ Issues of equity and inclusion

☒ Low number of professionally trained educators

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Lack of support to families

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

(2021-2022), 72.3% of preschool children attended kindergarten, 21.6% of children did not attend kindergarten due to family choice, and 6.2% could not attend kindergarten due to various hindering conditions. 12.4% of children living in rural areas and 1.1% of children living in cities have access to preschool education. The main obstacles to preschool education are the lack of a kindergarten near the place of residence and being placed on a waiting list.

In 2016, the Law on Early and Preschool Education was adopted in Georgia. In 2017, the state standards of early and preschool education, the professional standard of the educator-pedagogue.

"Early Education Curriculum -Play" has been implemented since 2022.

The level of satisfaction with the quality of formal education is very high. 93.6% of parents/family members of children in kindergarten are satisfied with the quality of preschool education.

61% of teachers have relevant education. According to the requested information, in 2022 there were 8450 educators working in public institutions. 5,238 educators had the requirements defined by the professional standard of the educator-pedagogue - higher education and 4 years of work experience in kindergarten, professional education in the direction of preschool education (according to the information received in 2019).

In 2021 a mandatory training module for kindergarten teachers was approved. Since 2021, 2154 people were successfully trained with the training module.

(Thematic research report. Committee on Education, Science and Youth of the Parliament of Georgia).

2.2 Primary and secondary education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

The age for enrolment in primary education is 6.

Duration of primary education is 6 years.

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

☒ Primary education is compulsory

☐ Primary education is **not** compulsory.

☒ Primary education is free of charge.

☐ Primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- **CONSTITUTION OF GEORGIA**

- **Article 27 – Right to education and academic freedom**

- 1. Everyone has the right to receive education and the right to choose the form of education they receive.

- 2. Pre-school education shall be guaranteed in accordance with the procedures established by law. Elementary and basic education shall be compulsory. General education shall be fully funded by the State, in accordance with the procedures established by law.

- **Law of Georgia on General Education**

- Article 6.

11. Primary schooling of general education shall begin at the age of six.

According to Article 9 of the Law of Georgia "On General Education":

"1. Everyone has an equal right to complete full general education in order to fully develop their personality and acquire the knowledge and skills necessary for equal opportunities for success in private and public life. Primary and basic education is mandatory.

1. To ensure general education, the state creates a general education system and appropriate socio-economic conditions.

All public-school students are provided with school textbooks free of charge by the state. Uniforms are not required in public schools.

The Social Service Agency and local municipalities have targeted financial assistance allocated to help vulnerable families with children, including for providing school supplies.

There is a school in every settlement of Georgia. If there is no school near the home for a child, the state provides transportation service to students to the nearest school free of charge.

- Ordinance of the Government of Georgia, N476, 14/09/2015 "On the determination of the financial norm for financing general education and the amount of the corresponding standard voucher for one student". **Full general education in public schools is free of charge.**

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Limited access | ☒ Poor learning outcomes in: |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | Foundation literacy |
| ☐ High dropout rates | Numeracy |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | Social and emotional learning |
| ☐ Other: | Others |
| | ☒ Disparity in learning outcomes |
| | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

From age 12 to age 14.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

From age 15 to age 17.

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

- ☒ Lower secondary education is compulsory.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☒ Lower secondary education is free of charge.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is compulsory.
- ☒ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☒ Upper secondary education is free of charge
- ☐ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

• **Article 27 – Right to education and academic freedom**

1. Everyone has the right to receive education and the right to choose the form of education they receive.
 2. Pre-school education shall be guaranteed in accordance with the procedures established by law. Elementary and basic education shall be compulsory. General education shall be fully funded by the State, in accordance with the procedures established by law.
- Ordinance of the Government of Georgia, N476, 14/09/2015 "On the determination of the financial norm for financing general education and the amount of the corresponding standard voucher for one student".

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of

employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

ORGANIC LAW OF GEORGIA – LABOUR CODE OF GEORGIA

Article 10 – Emergence of legal capacity to enter into employment agreements and minimum employment age

1. The legal capacity of natural persons to enter into an employment agreement shall commence from the age of 16.

2. The legal capacity of minors under the age 16 to enter into an employment agreement shall derive from the consent of their legal representative or a custody/guardianship authority, unless the labour relations in question are contrary to the minor's interests, or prejudice their moral, physical and mental development, or limit their right and opportunity to acquire compulsory primary and basic education. Where the consent of a minor's legal representative or custody/guardianship authority validly constitutes legal capacity to enter into an employment agreement, such consent shall be valid with respect to similar types of subsequent labour relations as well.

3. An employment agreement with minors under the age 14 may be concluded solely for the performance of activities in the fields of sport, art, and culture, and/or to do work in advertising.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Limited access | ☒ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☒ Low readiness of primary graduates |
| ☐ High dropout rates | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.3 Higher education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3³⁹, and target 4.4⁴⁰. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☐ Higher education is free of charge
- ☐ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☐ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).
- ☐ Other:

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Maximum amount of tuition fee at state universities are fixed to the size of state education grant (2250 GEL). State funding for Higher Education is secured through merit-based and needs-based education grants, as well funds allocated to the state universities for financing priority fields. State education grants, awarded to the best scoring students in the UNE entrance exam provide secondary school graduates with an opportunity to continue their education at higher education level both at public and private universities. Foreign citizens passing unified national exams are funded under special program designed purposefully for them.

20% of state education grants are annually allocated for the social grants program. Needs-based grants are awarded to students with different social background: students from highland areas; graduates from minority schools (Azerbaijani and Armenian); students from families of the militaries Killed in Actions and Missing in Actions; repatriates; orphans and students from large families, students under the state care; students affected by Russian

³⁹ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

⁴⁰ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

aggression; students from the occupied territories; students with special education needs/disabilities; socially vulnerable students

In addition to this, the Ministry developed the special preparatory program for the university entrants from the Occupied territories of Georgia to ensure their access to higher education in Georgian universities.

In addition, state scholarships for the best performing students are awarded annually, under the special support program.

Besides, “1+4 Program” is a higher education opportunity for ethnic minorities available as an accredited, special one-year preparatory program in Georgian language. Beneficiaries of the Program are financed for one-year language course and Bachelor studies for the duration of the educational program in authorized higher educational institutions.

University entrants are entitled to pursue their studies on the mentioned program, if they pass one of the following tests in Unified National Examinations:

- Azerbaijani-language general skills test;
- Armenian-language general skills test;
- Ossetian-language test;
- Abkhazian-language test.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Low number of professionally trained professors |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☐ Poor learning outcomes | |
| ☒ Other: | |

Regarding **Higher Education** the main challenge is existing funding mechanisms, which provide higher education institutions and students with insufficient incentives for enhancing quality. The main funding source for higher education institutions is tuition fees, covered by state grants and households.

The current challenges have been identified through SWOT analysis conducted by the **National Centre for Educational Quality Enhancement** that involved identifying external macro-environmental factors, as well as internal organizational processes and resources impacting quality assurance with the involvement of broad stakeholders.

- Implementation of non-formal education recognition mechanisms in higher education;
- Introduction of micro-credentials in the higher education system;
- Absence of a credit transfer mechanism from Higher Vocational Education to Higher Education level;
- Quality Culture within the education institutions;
- Digitalization of Educational Services.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

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2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- ☐ Provision of literacy programmes
- ☒ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)
- ☒ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- ☒ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes
- ☒ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning
- ☒ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling
- ☐ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.
- ☐ Other:

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- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

In 2019, Georgia's formal education system introduced new educational services. The system has been transformed, and the private sector with an educational component and non-standard qualifications has been added to existing providers and qualifications. Short-term vocational training-retraining programs became part of formal education, which means that a certificate recognized by the state will be issued upon completion of a relevant short-term course. This opportunity to teach adult learners certain competencies and skills in a relatively short period of time through vocational training and retraining programs is attractive for

employers looking to hire qualified personnel for performing specific tasks, as well as for people who want to improve their professional skills and advance their careers.

The aforementioned change in the formal education system has several objectives: (1) meeting the needs of the labour market in a relatively short period of time; (2) involving employers in the implementation of programs to improve their quality and relevance or programs and (3) activating the adult population in the labour market.

Any legal entity such as a private company, training center, association, or educational institute, etc can obtain the right to provide vocational training and retraining, either individually or jointly with other institutions, as long as they meet the standards established by the government of Georgia. All short-term programs are conducted in the form of work-based learning and meet the following criteria: program efficiency, human resource availability, and institutional efficiency. The vocational training and retraining programs electronic system, developed by the LEPL Education Management Information System, supports the conduction of processes in an electronic format.

It's worth noting that systematized service, flexible quality assurance mechanisms, and state funding opportunities stimulate the involvement of the private sector in delivering short-term programs. As a result, the number of private sector providers is increasing from year to year. What makes the service even more attractive is the fact that the program provider is not restricted by existing qualifications and programs. The provider can create an entirely new program and submit it, along with relevant justification for acquiring the right of implementation.

Vocational training and retraining programs are available to all interested persons. Information on the programs can be obtained on the electronic platform vet.emis.ge. Any person wishing to apply to CVET programs registers on the mentioned web portal and then goes through the selection procedure defined for the specific program, which may include a motivational interview, written tests, practice testing, etc. Programs are available year-round.

There are two mechanisms of state funding - 1. Skills agency fully or partially finance all providers that obtain the right to provide vocational training/retraining program and 2. State employment support agency finance job-seekers to take the course. The funding mechanism of skills agency is particularly proactive for engaging private sector in the delivering short-term programs. Additional support services are available for PWDs and SEN (Sign language interpreter, mobility orientation specialist, transportation, etc). Most training and retraining programs are tailored to the needs of adults and offer students a flexible schedule.

From 2021 to nowadays more than 500 new training/retraining programs were developed. The total enrollment in the CVET sector has grown significantly in recent years. From 2021 - to nowadays the number of enrolments is more than 17,800.

Since 2019, vocational education system allows learning results achieved within the framework of non-formal education to be recognized at the level of vocational education. In accordance with the regulation, the institution implementing the vocational education program and the legal entity authorized to implement the vocational training/retraining program are authorized to recognize non-formal education, if the organization meets the requirements established for obtaining the right to recognize non-formal education.

Vocational educational institutions in Georgia offer a career support service that provides free-of-charge assistance to all interested individuals. These services are available to both current and prospective vocational students. Career Management Specialists continuously offer updated information regarding employment opportunities and further career development possibilities to students and graduates. Additionally, these institutions periodically conduct research on the employment outcomes of their students and graduates. Based on the feedback from these studies, the institutions improve the quality of their career services.

Since 2023, Skills Agency has been working on introducing a career education course designed to help vocational students develop their career guidance skills. This course equips students with the necessary tools to make informed career decisions. The pilot program has been implemented in six educational institutions, and there are plans to expand the course to all vocational educational institutions. This service is also provided free of charge to students.

Skills Agency is also in the process of introducing a new concept of "open door" service in all vocational educational institutions. This service aims to promote vocational education, increase public awareness, and support individuals in the process of career self-determination. The "open door" service has been piloted in seven institutions. By offering these services, the agency seeks to enhance the overall effectiveness and reach of career guidance and counselling in the vocational education system.

The provision of free-of-charge career guidance and counselling in Georgia's vocational education system is a vital component in supporting students' educational and professional success. By continuously updating and expanding these services, Georgia ensures that vocational students are well-prepared to enter the workforce and achieve their career aspirations.

A special electronic platform for training and retraining programs for adults has been created and is operational. This platform ensures that the right to implement these programs is handled electronically. Additionally, it facilitates the registration, enrollment, and granting of graduate status for participants in these programs.

There are nearly 360 Special Education Needs students at Vocation Education level. There are 62 specialists in inclusive professional education.

With regard to adult education, Zurab Zhvania School of Public Administration (ZSPA) LEPL, established in 2005, operating under the umbrella of the Ministry of Education, Science and Youth of Georgia, is the leading institution that provides State language teaching to ethnic minorities, asylum seekers, persons with international protection in Georgia and other target groups at no cost and thereby supports their full-fledged integration into society as well as professional skills development of public officials in the municipal bodies within two main programme directions: **The State Language Teaching and Integration Programme and Public Management and Administration Programme.**

Employing customized teaching methods, the SZPA ensures no one is left behind, reaching all, including the most vulnerable groups living in the most remote areas through the Training Centres, mobile groups and online format teaching.

The school has 12 training centres, which are distributed over four regions in Georgia, specifically Kutaisi, Akhalkalaki, Ninotsminda, Akhaltsikhe, Bolnisi, Dmanisi, Tsalka, Marneuli, Gardabani, Lagodekhi, Sagarejo, and Akhmeta, conducting face-to-face teaching in a group format at these centres. In regions where the learning centres are far from the beneficiary's place of residence and there is a demand from their side, the institution goes to great lengths to ensure maximum accessibility by creating mobile groups on the ground in a face-to-face format, primarily in the premises of public schools, preschool institutions, administration of municipal bodies, public service halls, and community centres. The school significantly expanded its geographic coverage throughout the years to 63 geographic areas in 2024, while the teaching process was provided in 7 locations in 2021 (2022 – 32, 2023 - 57).

The State Language Teaching and Integration Programme provides 25 State language training courses for improving general competencies in Georgian language proficiency (Beginners Georgian (A1.1 A1.2), Basic Georgian (A2.1, A2.2), General Georgian (B1.1, B1.2), Alphabetic Georgian, Communication Georgian), as well as 17 professional courses saturated with sectoral vocabulary, that helps the beneficiaries not only to advance the language skills but to better integrate into the respective professional field:

- | | |
|---|----------------------------|
| • Civic Education | • Construction |
| • Finance | • Food Technologies |
| • Procurement | • Animal husbandry |
| • Jurisprudence | • Agronomy |
| • Infrastructure | • Electricity |
| • Support course for teachers (I and II course) | • Accounting |
| • Nursing work | • Tourism |
| • Management | • Information Technologies |
| • Transport | |
| • | |

The school's growing influence and impact have been witnessed throughout the years, resulting in a significant rise in the number of beneficiaries with diverse ethnic and linguistic backgrounds, reaching up to 5,500 in 2023 compared to previous years (3919 beneficiaries in 2021, 5125 in 2022). In 2024, already 3,010 beneficiaries have been involved in the programme. In 2022-2023, the ZSPA introduced and approved the Integration Course for Public Officials. The programme is designed to help improve their language competencies in general and sector-specific areas, develop their professional skills, use the state language efficiently in the workplace, and strengthen their cooperation with Georgian-speaking colleagues through mutual experience-sharing. This ensures their rapid and efficient integration into the public governance sphere. The program includes three thematic courses embedded with the components of professional integration, including practice in municipal administrations and other public institutions, as well as language and cultural integration:

- An introductory course in municipal management
- A general course in municipal management
- A specialized course in municipal management

The pilot cycle of the Integration Course for Public Officials included 21 civil servants of ethnic minority backgrounds.

Within the second programme direction of **Public Management and Administration**, the ZSPA provides two accredited basic programs for the professional development of public servants - **"Development of Managerial Skills"** and **"Development of Personal and Professional Competencies"** defined by the Government resolution #Nº242 (22.05.2018) on the "Rule of determining the professional development needs of a public servant, and rule of adopting professional development standard. These programmes, by promoting the professional development of the officials through enhancing their theoretical knowledge and practical skills, contribute to establishing a high professional standard in public service. Besides, the following additional programs are available for the representatives of specific fields of particular sectors:

- Human Resources Management;

- Communication psychology for human resources management specialists;
- Case management and electronic governance (for school personnel);
- Case management and electronic governance (for civil servants);
- Public Finance management;
- Program Budgeting;
- Accounting;
- Internal audit in public administration;
- Basics of Public Relations;
- Communication psychology for public relations management specialists;
- Political PR;
- Effective technologies for citizen service;
- Civil construction, norms and implementation of technical supervision;
- Construction of drinking water mains and their technical supervision;
- Technical supervision of road construction and renovation;
- Administrative supervision and fines;
- Municipal permits and fees;
- Spatial-territorial development of the municipality;
- Fundraising;
- Municipal property management;
- Gender policy, gender equality and elimination of sexual harassment;
- Maintenance of the school building and its infrastructure;
- Service and quality management and ethics in public service;

In 2023, 30 civil servants retrained from the basic programmes, while 60 staff employed in general educational institutions (who are responsible for the maintenance/ownership of the school, for example, principals, service personnel, school MNE and school technical staff), as well as for the responsible persons of the relevant local government agency involved in the maintenance/ownership of the school benefited from the training course "Maintenance/ownership of the school building and its infrastructure". From 2021 till 2024 (as of 1 June, 2024), 433 persons employed in budgetary organizations enjoyed the training opportunities provided by the **Public Management and Administration Programme**.

The Zurab Zhvania School of Public Administration employs constant quality control and development during its everyday work and further development - the respective structural units of the school conduct quality monitoring and management to refine and subsequently advance the strategies and methods. The ZSPA has enforced a quality management system since 2015, which adheres to the international standard ISO 9001 requirements. On December 20, 2023, the school underwent a supervisory audit by the certifier, which affirmed the compliance of the school and its management system with the latest version of the international standard ISO 9001:2015. The quality control system of the school is a comprehensive process that involves various forms of evaluation, monitoring, and development and is designed to ensure the smooth functioning of the educational process and maximize the satisfaction of the beneficiaries.

Since its establishment, the school has been relentlessly pursuing internationalization and institutional and structural strengthening to expand its activities based on state interests. The ZSPA is a member of The Network of Directors of Institutes and Schools of Public Administration

(DISPA)), actively participating in its work, as well as in the activities of the Network of Schools of Government (NSG) of OECD.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Limited access | ☐ Limited funding |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☐ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

A gap is observed in the accessibility reskilling/upskilling programs and other lifelong learning opportunities for adults. Access to continuous VET is constrained by a limited number of places against a backdrop of rising demand.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☒ Student-teacher ratio
- ☒ School fees (if relevant)
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

LEPL Office of Resource Officers of Educational Institutions (ORO) under MoES was set up to ensure safe and psychologically healthy environment for children at schools across Georgia. The ORO employs Resource officers, psychologists, psychiatrists and social workers.

In accordance with the Georgian legislation, since teachers, social workers, psychologists, psychiatrists and school resource officers are the public sector actors that work most closely with students and are often aware of the children's rights violations, they are obliged to report suspected violence/ violence to the relevant authorities.

The ORO has 10 psycho-social service centers throughout Georgia. The Centers provide qualified, free of charge psychological services to students, their parents and school representatives. Center operates a 24-hour hotline to provide timely and immediate psychological counseling, as well as, deliver the necessary information to service recipients.

In November 2023, the Parliament of Georgia amended the Law of Georgia on General Education. According to the amendments, the provision of all state services supporting inclusive education of learners with special educational needs and disabilities (psychoeducational assessment and counselling service) is placed under the leadership of the Office of Resource Officers of Educational Institutions of Georgia. Inclusive and Special Education Support Center (division) has already been established at the Office of Resource Officers of Educational Institutions. Currently, hiring managerial staff of the center is in progress.

For the first time in the educational institutions of Georgia, in 2021, Social Work component has been introduced in educational institutions, in accordance to the "law on Social Work of Georgia" adopted by the Parliament of Georgia in 2018, as well as in full compliance with the regulations issued by the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia - "Rule on Professional Standards of Social Work and Social Worker's Organizational-Technical and Infrastructural Provision" (order N22/N), approved on January 27, 2022, and "social work safety rules" (order N104/N), approved on December 29, 2021.

The Social work model has been developed together with local and European experts. More than 65 social workers have been hired by the Office of Resource Officers of the Ministry of Education and Science of Georgia and deployed to 70 public schools. All of them have received basic in-house trainings as well as demands-led trainings on sexual abuse, sexual harassment, domestic violence, stalking, economic violence, violence against girls, women, most vulnerable groups/monitories.

The ORO representatives regularly carry out informative, educational and social-skill activities in the public schools for students, teachers, parents and school representatives on human rights, equality, diversity, hate speech, nondiscriminatory approach and harmful practices.

LEPL-Education and Science Infrastructure Development Agency (ESIDA) carries out construction/rehabilitation works of educational buildings, taking into account the priorities agreed with the Ministry of Education, Science and Youth. The construction/rehabilitation process is regulated by the technical regulations of the "National Accessibility Standards" approved by the Resolution N734 of the Government of Georgia of December 4, 2020 and the Resolution No. 41 of the Government of Georgia of January 28, 2016 "On the Regulation and Technical Approval of the Arrangement of Space and Architectural and Planning Elements". Accordingly, the rehabilitation and construction of educational institutions is implemented in compliance with the requirements of the mentioned regulation. As a result, newly built

educational institutions (schools, colleges) are fully adapted and equipped with an environment adapted for disabled people. In relation to partially adapted schools, it should be noted that, if the arrangement of an adapted environment can lead to the creation of a threat to the stability of the existing building of the educational institution, the mentioned technical regulation is taken into account as much as possible, within the technical capabilities of the building.

The Education and Scientific Infrastructure Development Agency of the Ministry of Education, Science and Youth of Georgia is implementing an unprecedented large-scale project, which involves the construction and rehabilitation of public schools in Georgia.

· At this stage, 171 schools are being constructed and rehabilitated by the Agency. In particular, the construction of 77 schools, and the complete rehabilitation of 94 school buildings. The total cost is 915,375,465 GEL.

· During the reporting period throughout Georgia: the construction of 4 schools was completed, 12 schools were fully rehabilitated, and about 150 schools were partially rehabilitated. The total cost of infrastructure projects is more than 54,500,000 GEL.

· During the last few years, the Municipal Development Fund of the Ministry of Regional Development and Infrastructure of Georgia has implemented the construction/rehabilitation of 138 schools, the construction and rehabilitation of 42 schools is in progress and the construction/rehabilitation of 11 schools are planned.

In order for educational institutions to gain the right to implement **vocational education** programs, they must meet the standards of authorization of vocational educational institutions defined by the Order of the Minister of Education and Science of Georgia of October 1, 2010 №99 /n - "On the Authorization Regulations and Approval of Fees", according to which, the authorized institutions in the field of vocational education are obliged to offer a suitable environment to vocational students and provide access to appropriate infrastructure and study materials.

By the Education and Scientific Infrastructure Development Agency:

- Construction of 2 new professional colleges was completed;
- Construction of 3 professional colleges is underway;
- The construction of 4 training workshops was completed;
- Construction of 2 training workshops is underway;
- In 4 locations, the training spaces of the educational institution were rehabilitated.

Higher education institutions in Georgia are required by law to work in compliance with the internal and external quality assurance standards. Nowadays, Georgia's system of external quality assurance comprises of institutional authorization and programme accreditation, while internal quality has functions on both institutional and programme levels to ensure the continuous evaluation and development of the quality of teaching, learning and research processes, professional development of staff and quality of the services and facilities provided by the institution.

Authorization of HEIs is an external mechanism of higher education quality assurance, which is carried out by the NCEQE. Authorization is an institutional evaluation, which determines compliance of an institution with the authorization standards. The evaluation process is carried out by expert panel and is based on the analysis of the information provided in the self-evaluation report (SER) of the institution and collected during the site-visit. Authorization is

obligatory for all HEIs in order to be allowed to carry out educational activities and issue a diploma that is recognized by the state.

Accreditation of higher education programmes is an external mechanism of higher education quality assurance, which is carried out by the NCEQE. Accreditation is a programme evaluation, which determines compliance of a programme with the accreditation standards. The evaluation is carried out by the accreditation experts' panel and is based on the analysis of the information indicated in the self-evaluation report of the programme and collected during the experts' site-visit. Accreditation is obligatory for regulated professions (Medicine, Law, Teacher Education, Maritime Education, Veterinary) and doctoral programmes. It is not obligatory to be accredited for the rest of the programmes. However, higher education programme has to be accredited in order to be eligible for national grants.

LEPL National Centre for Educational Quality Enhancement (NCEQE) under the Ministry has developed quality assurance standards in early and preschool, general, vocational and higher education and undertakes external quality evaluations that establishes and encourages minimum standards and norms in education.

The NCEQE has considered conditions relating to the quality of education in its higher education quality assurance standards. Evaluation of infrastructure is a part of a Standard 7 -Material, information and financial resources. It considers to evaluate infrastructure and its safety for students and staff, environment necessary for implementing educational activities and adapted environment for people with special needs. Teaching materials are also evaluated within standard 7, in material resources.

Evaluation of learner/teacher ratios is a part of a Standard 4 - Staff of the HEI. It considers to evaluate ratios at institutions to evaluate staff workload and therefore quality of program implementations within workloads and ratios.

Use of ICT has a crucial part in evaluation standards, it is evaluated in Standard 7 as a part of information resources infrastructure, also it is evaluated in standard 2, as it is considered to be a part of effective management of the institution.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Violence in schools | ☐ Inadequate parental support to education |
| ☐ Cost of education | ☐ Long distances to schools |
| ☐ Conflicts or crises | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.2 Education personnel

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.
- ☒ Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- ☒ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- ☒ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- ☐ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.
- ☐ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.
- ☐ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.
- ☐ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.
- ☒ Other:

The National Center for the Teacher Professional Development (TPDC) offers a range of professional development services for teachers and principals, including online and offline trainings, seminars, workshops, master classes, webinars. The training modules focus on student-centred approaches and competence-based teaching and learning. They encompass three key dimensions: subject knowledge, crosscutting competencies and teaching methodology.

Additionally, TPDC develops a variety of educational resources in different formats for the school community. These resources are uploaded on the Education E-house portal (<https://educationhouse.ge>). Currently, more than 2 105 resources are accessible on the platform. The resources cover a wide range of topics, which are designed to familiarize beneficiaries with the goals and strategies of the education system, provide various teaching methods and guides, offer engaging student activities, provide useful information related to subject topics, as well as cross-curricular themes.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

To Develop VET Teachers policy and development strategy model of the appropriate regulatory framework have been created with the following documents: Teachers' Standards, model of Teachers Commencement of Work, Professional Development and Career Advancement, new model of compensation and evaluation system. The model is deliberated with the diverse range of stakeholders. According to the model and appropriate research and piloting processes Pre-Service and In-Service programs and appropriate modules have been tailored for future implementation.

In order to establish teachers' evaluation system and implement CPD model appropriate research and piloting processes have been conducted across various VET Institutions.

Analyze of teachers' evaluation research and piloting of teachers' self-assessment form significantly contributed the refinement and development of the model.

With the collaboration of international partners, a comprehensive CPD manual was created accompanied by training sessions for certain administrative representatives of VET Institutions.

One of the most important approaches is to stimulate VET teacher partnerships and school-to-school cooperation in order to shift centralized training system to a more cooperative and practice-based model. To achieve this goal, the Skills Agency within the subprogram for "Innovative learning-teaching Support", approved by Order N1653889 of 26 December 2022 of General Director of Skills Agency, facilitated the process of developing teacher networks and coaching practices. Additionally, the concept of TVET teachers' sectoral networks has been developed, which is focused on the benefits of peer cooperation and offers ways for teachers' collaboration

In order to provide teachers with the opportunity to continuous professional development, skills agency during the period 2022-2023 has offered the in-service training for the VET teachers throughout the country. As a result, around 900 teachers were trained in teaching and students assessment methods, including utilizing electronic resources and digital tools in learning process. In order to ensure accessibility, trainings were held in the mountainous regions of Georgia as well.

Additionally, Skills agency has created the draft version of the pre-service program which is focused on preparation of new teachers in the VET system. Program is aimed to equip new teachers with all the necessary skills and knowledge to lead the learning process.

In accordance with the institutional development policy and in order to promote the diversification of opportunities for continuous professional development of vocational education teachers, in 2023, sectoral networks of vocational education teachers were created in 18 directions, which unite more than 1,300 teachers with from all public and private institutions. Sectoral networks enable teachers to share and gain experience with peers effectively as skills agency support networks by organizing workshops/webinars for them.

In order to boost teacher professional development skills agency has offered grant competitions for the VET teachers which aims to develop digital learning materials by teachers. Grant competition enables teachers to increase their role at the institutional level and initiate projects that are needed for the learning process.

In 2024, Skills agency has developed mechanism to enable teachers to get an international experience by participating in the study visits at the partner institutions within the Europe. As a result of pilot initiative, approximately 50 teachers will have been participating in the visits.

The salary of a vocational education teachers has increased 3 times in the last few years - by 20% in 2023 and in 2024 it will be increased by 10%.

Institutional evaluation standards for higher education institutions consider initial training and continuous professional development and performance monitoring system.

Institutional evaluation Standard 4 requires constant provision of its staff with professional development opportunities and improved work conditions and asks for professional development mechanisms.

Moreover, institution has to have a developed performance evaluation system for its staff (academic, scientific, invited, administrative and support staff)

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

- ☒ Shortages of teaching staff
- ☐ Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff
- ☒ Lack of training centres
- ☐ Other:
- ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials
- ☐ High student – teacher ratio

Skills agency is in the process of tailoring mechanism for teacher professional development model. Before the system is created for the CPD, skills agency offers in-service opportunities based on the need identified periodically. Currently, the challenge for the system is to answer teachers' the needs especially for the novice teachers. nevertheless, the draft version of pre-service program exists, there is a lack of the center/institution which will provide teachers preparation trainings.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

There is a shortage of certain subject teachers in schools, physics being a notable example. This is particularly evident in certain regions of Georgia.

Additionally, there is a scarcity of other subject teachers in the mountainous regions of the country.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.⁴¹ Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Curriculum includes human rights education.

⁴¹

Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

☒ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.

☒ Other:

The National Center for Teacher Professional Development (TPDC) participates in the development of teacher professional development policies, implements professional development programs. TPDC aims to establish education as a core value while protecting children's rights and ensuring access to quality education, alongside with enhancing human rights teaching in schools. To achieve this, TPDC:

1. Is actively involved in promoting implementation of the Council of Europe's "Reference Framework of Competences for Democratic Culture", which is a tool to implement Human Rights Education. In 2018 state program "Democratic Culture and Human Rights Education at Schools," was launched. The given program aims to promote competences for democratic culture in schools through professional development of teachers, to provide the educational process oriented on human rights education, prevention of discrimination and development of safe and tolerant learning environment, to equip teachers and the school community with appropriate knowledge, skills and resources. Within the framework of the program, the cooperation with various organizations at the local or international level and the Council of Europe and the European Union is in progress. Council of Europe has developed a platform Democratic Schools Network, where school projects are presented on a dedicated webpage so thousands of education practitioners across Europe can learn about it and Georgian schools also became a member of the Democratic Schools Network.
2. Provides teachers with training modules that address issues of human and children's rights, violence against children, discrimination. Teachers on their part, are able to transfer and use the acquired knowledge/information in the classroom the following number of teachers participated in trainings, where human and children rights were discussed:
 - Training modul: "**Competencies of Democratic Culture**" (online format)- 689 teachers were trained in 2021 ;
 - Training module: "**General Course for Civic Education Teachers**"- 65 teachers were trained in 2021 ;
 - Training module: "**Teaching Peace - Peace Processes**", the following number of teachers were trained :
 - 521 teachers in 2021 ;
 - 102 teachers in 2022 ;
 - 276 teachers in 2023;
 - Training module: "**Overcoming Violence against Children, INSPAIR strategies**", the following number of teachers were trained:
 - 249 teachers in 2022;
 - 364 teachers in 2023.
 - Training-module : „**Sexual and Reproductive Health for Teachers**" on the Edx platform. 25 teachers were trained in 2023.
 - Training module: "**Preventing Bullying in Schools and Promoting the Development of a Tolerant Culture**" –13320 teachers were trained on the Open Edx platform in 2023.

- Training module "***Discrimination, Racism, Modern Challenges and Approaches in Education***", 26 teachers were trained in 2022.

The ORO specialists (resource officers, social workers and psychologists) regularly carry out informative, educational and social-skill development activities, using evidence-based materials and resources for school students, teachers, parents and school representatives on human rights, equality, diversity, hate speech, non-discriminatory approach and harmful practices.

The draft strategy for the development of vocational education in Georgia aims to promote the development of key competencies, particularly the progress of the key competence of democratic culture (CDC) at the level of vocational education is carried out in the form of a stand-alone general module of civic education and, through non-formal education.

- The module of civic education, revised in 2020 to bring it closer to the competence framework of democratic culture, is a stand-alone subject taught at majority of VET programs, includes the following learning outcomes: Understanding the democratic political system and the relationship between political actors and citizens
- Recognizing basic human rights and the mechanisms for their protection
- Solving problems within the community

The initiative to promote the development of student services and non-formal education "Implementation and development of extracurricular activities" launched in 2022 with the support of the Skills Agency. Extracurricular activities help students develop key competencies and life skills; activities include interactive non-formal educational initiatives on such important and relevant topics as, for example, digitisation and innovations, active citizenship and democracy, gender and inclusion, entrepreneurship, human rights etc. This initiative contributes to the diversity of student life and the introduction of various student services in VET institutions.

According to the Article 3. of the Law of Georgia on Higher Education, "promotion of the development of Georgian and global cultural values, orientation towards the ideals of democracy and humanism essential for the existence and development of a civil society is one of the goals of higher education."

According to the same article (3) In order to achieve the goals determined by paragraph 1 of this article higher education institutions shall ensure access to and openness of higher education, academic freedom, opportunity to acquire higher education at any time during a person's lifetime, participation of the academic personnel, scientific personnel and students in the process of making decisions and monitoring of their execution, publicity and transparency in managing a higher education institution and in competitions conducted in the institution, prohibition of any forms of discrimination in the field of higher education, including discrimination on any ground such as academic, ethnic, social or religious affiliation, and/or opinion, Gender and other grounds.

According to the Article 2 Academic freedom is the right of the academic personnel and students to carry out research, teaching and learning activities independently;

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

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3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision⁴².

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation⁴³ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:

☐ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:

☐ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:

☐ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:

- ☐ Registration
- ☐ State monitoring and inspections
- ☐ Qualifications of teachers
- ☐ Health and sanitation
- ☐ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☐ Infrastructure
- ☐ Curriculum
- ☐ Student-teacher ratio
- ☐ School fees
- ☐ School closures
- ☒ Other

⁴² Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

⁴³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

According to the Law of Georgia on Higher Education (9th Article, 2nd Paragraph) “A higher education institution shall be established in a form of a legal entity under public or private law”. Besides, external quality regulatory provisions apply equally to all types of higher education institutions operating across the country.

Higher education institutions in Georgia are required by law to work in compliance with the internal and external quality assurance standards.

Authorization standards and higher education regulatory laws are common for state and non-state (private) higher education institutions.

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials | ☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion |
| ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers | ☐ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity |
| ☐ High student – teacher ratio | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion⁴⁴.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

☒ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)

☐ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.

☐ Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content⁴⁵, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.

☒ Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.

☒ Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education

☐ Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.

☐ A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

In order to promote digital literacy among the target groups (teachers and school administration), the National Center for Teacher Professional Development (TPDC), implements the following sub-programs : "Science Support (STEM)" sup-program, "Democratic Culture, Human Rights Education and School Network (eTwinning) Empowerment" sup-program, "Education E-house" sub-program, which, among many other things, aim to equip teachers and the wider school community with adequate digital skills providing them with a variety of educational resources:

- Within the framework of the "Education E-house" sub-program, more than 2 105 resources are placed on the education e-house portal (<https://educationhouse.ge/>). The process of resources uploading continues. The topics covered in the resources are diverse and serve to: familiarize the beneficiaries with the goals and strategies of the education system, popularize the teaching profession, promote the continuous professional development of school administrators and teachers, provide support to parents and students.
- The "Science Support (STEM)" sup-program, offers a variety of services and products to STEAM teachers, where integration of technologies is vital to improving STEAM education and student outcomes. The STEAM lab also continues functioning in order to enhance Natural Science teacher professional development and contribute to the research skills development in students, using engineering components, the basics of computer programming (coding), using an opensource computer platform, using the Arduino

microcontroller.

37 STEAM clubs have been functioning within "Science Support (STEM)" sup-program in Tbilisi and regions of Georgia. Natural Science teachers and students are involved and actively participate in STEM activities carried out within the clubs.

- Georgia, through TPDC, continues to support the participation of Georgian schools in the EU digital programme "eTwinning". eTwinning community encourages almost 4800 eTwinners from Georgia to collaborate with colleagues from different European countries, share experiences and use digital tools to create projects together with their students. 1600 new teachers were registered on the ESEP portal in 2023-2024. In order to facilitate the development of digital literacy, 3742 teachers registered on the eTwinning (ESEP) portal were trained during 2022-2023 with different training modules ("Working on the eTwinning portal and initiating projects", "Media literacy and disinformation", "Climate change in my classroom");
- TPDC offers trainings not only to ICT teachers, but also offers trainings to various subject teachers which digital technologies were integrated with subject component.

Several important measures have been taken by the Government between 2021-2024:

1. The need for teachers to facilitate distance learning led to the creation of the el.ge platform, which is a public platform and contains a variety of educational and cognitive e-resources.
2. Education Management Information System (EMIS) also created and developed various learning resources, including "Interactive Alphabet," "Fun Math," and "Learning by Playing" and more.
3. Microsoft 365 and Microsoft Teams software licenses have been extended to both students and educators in every public school throughout Georgia. This initiative offers valuable resources to enhance the integration of technology within the education system. To boost distance learning, the el.ge platform has been integrated with Microsoft Teams. Additionally, it's worth mentioning that Teams was localized in the Georgian language, further enhancing its user-friendliness for the platform's users.
4. A series of training sessions and webinars focusing on digital literacy and cybersecurity were held for teachers, students and their parents.
5. A memorandum was signed with mobile Internet providers, within the framework of which students and teachers could purchase an Internet package at different prices (mobile.emis.ge).
6. In 2021-2022, 23744 students and 18254 teachers were registered in Mobile.emis.ge system.
7. Video and text instructions for various platforms have been created to facilitate online learning process.
8. A group was created on the social network Facebook, where the parties involved in the educational process could get information about various platforms and ask questions to the Ministry of Education and Science and the Education Management Information System (EMIS).
9. For over a decade, Georgia's Ministry of Education, Science and Youth provides each first grader a laptop within "My First Computer" program, distributing 55,000 yearly. Back in 2021-2024, digital education and Microsoft 365 became part of 2,086 public schools, proving valuable for remote learning during the COVID-19 pandemic.
10. Georgia's success in distance learning during the pandemic was recognized by the OECD among 98 countries (see the link below).

11. Regarding the internet connectivity in public schools, it's important to note that, all public schools (2086) have access to internet (Fiber optics around 70% else - Radio), corporate-standard wireless (Wi-Fi) networks have been successfully deployed in 500 public schools.

All **vocational education institutions** are equipped with computers in accordance with the number of students, which is regulated by the 5th standard of authorization in terms of material, financial and ICT resources. Students in computer labs, Fab LABs and libraries in vocational education institutions have the opportunity to develop digital competencies and apply them in the learning process under appropriate mentoring.

To ensure digital transformation in VET sector, teaching of digital skills is integrated into both curricular and extracurricular programs. As digital skills are considered one of the eight key competencies for Lifelong Learning, vocational education programs include a mandatory computer literacy course.

With the initiative of Skills Agency Georgia in 2023 “The Concept and Mechanisms for Incorporation of Digital and Blended Learning into VET institutions” has been developed, which covers the systemic challenges and opportunities and proposes strategic approaches to digital transformation and digital competencies.

To increase accessibility to VET education, and to support the e-learning process, in 2023 the Skills Agency within the framework of the “Modern Skills for Better Jobs Sector Development Programme”, developed an open-source LMS platform. At this stage, the platform offers over 50 courses in self-paced and blended learning formats, categorized into three groups: teacher professional development under Moodle Academy, key competency enhancement, and sector-specific professional courses.

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways | ☐ Limited access to internet and/or electricity |
| ☒ Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions | ☐ Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.) |
| ☐ inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks | ☐ Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale |
| | ☒ Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice |
| | ☒ Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

As technologies are constantly developing, it is necessary for teachers to be constantly involved in learning about the innovations in technology and being able to use these innovations in the teaching-learning process.

Digital Technologies are gaining more and more importance in TVET, but there are some major challenges that skills systems face on the way to digital transformation.

The digital divide and the uneven access to equipment, tools, resources, and competencies are the main barriers in promoting the digitalization of TVET in Georgia.

As digitalization transforms economies and societies, It triggers new policy changes that require a higher level of partnership between different policy actors. There are not yet developed strong policies and strategies for digitalization in the country and in the VET system. To ensure that the educational institutions and teaching staff have the needed capacity and skills, it is essential to adapt the policy to the newest trends and innovations.

Teachers' basic digital competencies are also a critical limiting factor in promoting digitalization in TVET. Digital competencies of teachers play a vital role in effectively integrating technology into their teaching and training practices, and providing TVET learners with needed digital skills. The lack of sufficient digital competencies in teachers is also the main barrier to using/creating digital tools and resources.

Skills agency has tailored the pre and in-service modules for developing teachers' digital competences. Piloting of the pre-service module has been completed in 2023. But the training for developing digital skills for teachers is still not the accessible as a part of the pre-service program and has not been implemented yet.

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☒ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☐ Monitoring results are made public. [Please provide the link:](#)

☒ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

☐ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.

- ☐ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.
- ☐ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.
- ☐ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.
- ☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

EMIS streamlines education through management information systems. Across General, Vocational, and Higher education, platforms like eSchool, eVet, and eUni automate processes:

- The General Education Management Information System (eSchool.emis.ge) is a comprehensive platform comprising interconnected systems designed to streamline various functions related to educational management and administration. eSchool stores personal data of students, parents, graduates, and personnel employed in general educational institutions, ensuring compliance with Georgian legislation on data protection.
In addition to these core functionalities, eSchool incorporates components such as a first-graders' registration system and an electronic school journal (eJournal). eJournal is an efficient tool that digitally manages educational data. It enables electronic registration and assessment of students, timely communication of important information to parents, recording of school events and assignments, and gathering statistical data on assessments and attendance, etc.
- Higher Education Management Information System (euni.emis.ge) is an electronic platform where personal and other types of data is collected, elaborated and kept in accordance to the Georgian legislation. This data is used for the higher educational process administration by the state and higher educational institutions as well as for statistics, analytics and relevant policy making. It is centralized system access to which is provided for authorized users only.

Vocational Education Management Information System (evet.emis.ge) is an electronic platform where personal and other types of data is collected, elaborated and kept in accordance to the Georgian legislation. This data is used for the vocational educational process administration by the state and vocational educational institutions as well as for statistics, analytics and relevant policy making. The system is interconnected with student registration processes, and funding calculations are derived from the data collected within the system. It is centralized system access to which is provided for authorized users only.

Zurab Zhvania School of Public Administration employs constant quality control and development during its everyday work and further development - the respective structural units of the School conduct quality monitoring and management to refine and subsequently advance the strategies and methods. The ZSPA has enforced a quality management system

since 2015, which adheres to the international standard ISO 9001 requirements. On December 20, 2023, the school underwent a supervisory audit by the certifier, which affirmed the compliance of the school and its management system with the latest version of the international standard ISO 9001:2015. The quality control system of the School is a comprehensive process that involves various forms of evaluation, monitoring, and development and is designed to ensure the smooth functioning of the educational process and maximize the satisfaction of the beneficiaries.

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Budgetary constraints | ☐ Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment |
| ☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels | ☐ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data |
| ☐ Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

- ☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages
- ☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources
- ☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments
- ☐ Other:

